



— Architect of the Indian Constitution —
Distinguished Proponent of Equality and Justice



On the Birth Anniversary of
Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Ji
we offer him our
heartfelt tributes



“ Dr. Bhimrao Ambedkar’s life is a unique example of struggle, knowledge and determination. His thoughts inspire us to build a society where every citizen receives equal rights, respect and opportunities. Let us adopt his ideals and pledge to fulfill his dream of social justice, equality and empowerment. ”

Bhagwant Singh Mann

Chief Minister, Punjab

State Level Function

April 14, 2026

Venue: Village Udesiyan, Adampur (Jalandhar)

Time: 10.00 AM



Department of Information and Public Relations, Punjab

DELHI ON HIGH ALERT

Traffic snarls at Delhi–Noida border amid workers’ protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Thousands of commuters faced severe disruption on Monday as violent protests by factory workers in Noida brought traffic to a standstill along key routes connecting the city with Delhi, prompting heightened security measures across the national capital.

The unrest led to massive congestion on arterial roads, including National Highway 9 and the Noida Link Road near the Chilla border, with queues of vehicles stretching for several kilometres during peak hours. Several thousand commuters were stranded for hours, with many taking to social media platform X to share their ordeal and seek intervention.

According to officials, a large number of workers from various industrial units gathered in the morning to press their long-pending demand for salary revision. The demonstration, however, escalated into violence in areas such as Phase-2 and Sector 60, where



incidents of arson, vandalism and stone-pelting were reported. Some protesters also set vehicles on fire, further aggravating the situation.

A Delhi Police officer said members of labour unions from Uttar Pradesh had assembled near the border and blocked key stretches, halting traffic movement. “Delhi Police and Noida Police personnel were deployed to manage the situation and divert traffic, but the heavy volume of vehicles compounded the chaos,” the officer said.

Commuters described

long delays and lack of movement. One office-goer said she had been stuck for over an hour after leaving home early morning, while another complained that vehicles had not moved “even a single inch” for a prolonged period. Some passengers travelling to railway stations also reported difficulties and appealed for train delays. The Delhi Traffic Police issued an advisory stating that traffic towards Noida from the Chilla border was severely affected due to the ongoing agitation. Commuters were advised to plan their journeys

accordingly and use alternative routes such as the Delhi-Noida Direct (DND) Flyway from Sarai Kale Khan or NH 24 via Kondli Bridge to enter Noida through Noida Mod. Meanwhile, the Delhi Police has been put on high alert to prevent any spillover of unrest into the city. Officials said several teams have been deployed at all motorable roads connecting Noida to different parts of Delhi, particularly at major border points with Uttar Pradesh. Strict vigil is being maintained, and thorough checking of vehicles is

One office-goer said she had been stuck for over an hr after leaving home early morning, while another complained that vehicles had not moved ‘even a single inch’

being carried out to ensure that no anti-social elements enter the city under the guise of the protest.

“Delhi Police is fully alert and vigilant. Adequate force has been deployed at all strategic locations. No one will be allowed to breach law and order,” a senior officer said.

Barricading has been intensified at key entry points, and additional personnel, including rapid response teams and paramilitary forces, have been stationed to respond swiftly to any untoward incident. Police said they are in constant coordination with their Uttar Pradesh counterparts and are closely monitoring the evolving situation.

Security has also been stepped up along the Haryana border as a precautionary measure, with enhanced checking and deployment to prevent any movement of protesters into Delhi from that side. Authorities said efforts were underway to clear the congestion and restore normal traffic flow at the earliest.

Umar Khalid seeks review of Supreme Court bail rejection

NEW DELHI: Student activist Umar Khalid has moved the Supreme Court seeking a review of a verdict that denied him bail while observing that there were reasonable grounds to believe the allegations levelled against him in connection with the conspiracy behind the 2020 Delhi riots.

A bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and N V Anjaria was requested by senior advocate Kapil Sibal, who appeared in the court for Khalid, to list the review petition in open court.

Sibal said the matter is coming up for consideration before the judges in chambers on April 16 and they have filed an application for an



open-court hearing.

Justice Kumar said, “We will look into the papers. If required, we will call it.”

According to the Supreme Court’s rules, review petitions are considered by judges who delivered a judgment or passed an order in chambers to remedy an apparent error or a resultant grave injustice that has been the consequence of

a decision of the apex court. Parties seeking a review can request judges for an open-court hearing to rectify the grave injustice caused due to the decision under review.

On January 5, Besides Khalid, the top court had refused bail to Sharjeel Imam but granted it to five others, saying all the accused do not stand on the same footing.

The court denied bail to Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam, citing prima facie roles under UAPA in the 2020 Delhi riots. Others were granted conditional bail. It said trial delay alone does not justify bail, stressing differing levels of culpability. PTI

Walkathon to raise Parkinson’s awareness

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: All India Institute of Medical Sciences, New Delhi will host a ‘Walk for PD’ walkathon on April 18 at Jawahar Lal Auditorium to raise awareness about Parkinson’s disease.

Organised by its Neurology Department with the theme “Bridge the Care Gap,” the 7 a.m. event is open to the public with free but mandatory registration. Participants will receive T-shirts and refreshments, while experts stress the importance of early diagnosis, treatment and reducing stigma through community engagement.

DFS orders hospital fire audits, floats EOI for inspections of commercial units across Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Fire Service has ordered immediate inspections of hospitals and invited agencies through an expression of interest to carry out large-scale audits of commercial establishments, including those operating in residential areas, according to official documents.

The two-pronged move comes in the backdrop of recent fire incidents, including the Palam blaze on March 18 that killed nine members of a family, and the fire at SCB Medical College Hospital in Cuttack, Odisha on March 16, where 12 people died. These incidents



have prompted authorities to tighten safety checks.

As per an office order dated March 20, issued in view of recent fire incidents and the heightened fire risk during the approaching summer season, all divisional officers and assistant divisional officers have been directed to carry out

The document states that officers must rigorously verify the functional status of all fire prevention and safety systems

immediate and comprehensive fire safety inspections in both government and private hospitals across Delhi.

The document states that officers must rigorously verify the functional status of all fire prevention and safety systems, with the exercise to be treated as a priority.

It further states that deputy chief fire officers have been tasked with submitting daily zonal inspection reports to headquarters for monitoring and consolidation, ensuring that the process is tracked closely and completed in a time-bound manner.

Delhi Fire Service has floated an EOI to expand fire safety inspections across commercial and mixed-use areas. While fire calls declined in 2025–26, overall emergencies rose. Budget allocations and infrastructure, including stations and equipment, have been enhanced, alongside awareness drives and Fire Service Week activities.

News at a glance

ASSOCIATES OF HASHIM BABA GANG NABBED

NEW DELHI: The Special Cell of the Delhi Police has arrested two associates of the Hashim Baba gang, including absconding shooter Shadab Ahmad alias Chappal, wanted in a 2024 murder case. He was held near Signature Bridge with a pistol and cartridges. Another accused, Mohammad Adi, was arrested earlier for allegedly identifying extortion targets. Further inquiry is underway.

INVESTMENT FRAUD MASTER-MIND CAUGHT FROM KERALA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested a key accused from Malappuram in an interstate investment fraud of over Rs 45 lakh. Jamsheed K (33), a “money handler”, allegedly routed around Rs 10 lakh through his account. The victim was duped into investing Rs 45.9 lakh via a fake trading app promising high returns. His account is linked to 21 cyber fraud complaints on the Samanvaya portal.

Girl plays on makeshift swing made of mother’s saree, strangled to death

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GURUGRAM: A moment of carelessness while playing at home resulted in the tragic death of a 13-year-old girl in the Sector 9 area of Gurugram, police said on Monday.

The girl, identified as Rani Kumar, was playing with her sisters on Sunday when she allegedly made a swing by hanging her mother’s saree from a grill on the wall of their house. While spinning around on the swing, the saree suddenly wrapped

around her neck and began to suffocate her, police added.

When her condition worsened, her family rushed her to a government hospital, where doctors declared her dead.

Rani’s father, Suresh Singh, who is originally from Sitamarhi district in Bihar, has been living on rent in Devi Lal Colony for several years. He works as a tailor and has three daughters.

“All my daughters were playing at home on Sunday evening. My wife and I were also present, but we had no idea

how it all happened”, Suresh said. The family mentioned that the girls often played in the house, making swings out of curtains or clothes. On Sunday evening, Rani used her mother’s saree to create a sturdy swing. Moments before tragedy struck, Rani’s two younger sisters were clapping with excitement while she spun in circles. While spinning, one end of the saree became entangled around Rani’s neck. As she continued to move, the saree tightened further. She was unable to scream for help. When

her younger sisters realised something was wrong, they raised an alarm.

When their parents found Rani hanging from the grill with the saree tangled around her neck, her face had changed colour. Suresh and his wife quickly pulled her down and rushed her to a nearby government hospital, but it was too late. A senior police officer stated that preliminary investigations indicate this was an accident. The police are continuing their investigation into the matter.

Two juveniles apprehended in Ashok Vihar park murder case

Victim dragged behind bushes, stabbed during attack

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Crime Branch of the Delhi Police has apprehended two juveniles in connection with a blind murder at Picnic Hut Park in Ashok Vihar earlier this month.

The case pertains to an FIR registered under Section 103(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita at Bharat Nagar police station. Acting on specific intelligence, a Crime Branch team traced the suspects near the Mukarba Chowk flyover and apprehended them on April 12.

Police said the breakthrough followed a tip-off received by Constable Ankush, who was informed that the suspects involved in the April 6 killing would arrive near the flyover to collect money from an associate. A trap was laid, and the two juveniles were intercepted and identified



by the informer before being taken into custody.

During questioning, the juveniles allegedly confessed to their involvement in the crime along with another associate, also a minor. According to police, the murder was carried out in retaliation for a quarrel at the same park around two months ago, during which one of the accused was assaulted.

On April 6, the trio allegedly confronted the victim,

“The murder was carried out in retaliation for a quarrel at the same park around 2 months ago, during which one of the accused was assaulted”

dragged him behind bushes and assaulted him. When he resisted, two of them restrained him while the third stabbed him with a dagger-like weapon, causing fatal injuries, before fleeing the spot. Police said due legal procedures have been completed, and the juveniles have been handed over to the investigating officer. Efforts are underway to trace the third accused, and further investigation is in progress.

Capital’s landfill woes persist, MCD plans to add more waste processing installations

Ghazipur, Bhalswa, Okhla continue to carry massive legacy waste loads

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi’s three towering landfill sites continue to loom large over the city’s waste management challenge, with fresh data showing that biomineral and legacy waste clearance remain work in progress, even as thousands of tonnes are handled daily.

According to officials, at Okhla, about 23.04 lakh metric tonnes of legacy waste (accumulated, long-term municipal solid waste stored in dumpsites or landfills for years) remained as of December-end, with an additional 3.34 lakh metric tonnes of fresh waste, taking the total to 26.38 lakh metric tonnes. The Bhalswa landfill site poses a steeper challenge, with 36.52 lakh metric tonnes of legacy waste and 11.45 lakh metric tonnes of fresh accumulation, bringing its total burden



to 47.97 lakh metric tonnes. Ghazipur, long seen as one of the city’s most visible garbage mountains, continues to carry the heaviest load at 77.29 lakh metric tonnes, according to the officials.

Delhi generates over 14,000 tonnes of municipal solid waste every day, underlining the scale of the capital’s daily sanitation challenge even as processing capacities remain higher on paper.

According to recent daily reports, the city recorded waste

City recorded waste collection of 14,076 tonnes on Mar 27, which rose to 14,525 tonnes on Mar 28

collection of 14,076 tonnes on March 27, which rose to 14,525 tonnes on March 28 and further to 14,656 tonnes on March 29. Sandeep Kapoor, the chairman of MCD’s Department of Environment Management Services (DEMS), said that new installations to process fresh waste into manure will start functioning in the coming weeks, and the timeline to clean up the landfill sites will hopefully be achieved.

“Tenders have already been floated to process 6000 mt/day

fresh waste into manure; these installations will start functioning in a few weeks”, he said, adding that this installation will increase the waste processing capacity as the corporation is currently monitoring daily waste collection and every month. Officials noted that the steady rise reflects routine fluctuations across zones, with higher volumes often linked to market activity and population density in different parts of the city.

Delhi processed 17,621–18,396 tonnes of waste on select March days, with waste-to-energy plants and biomineral helping reduce the load. However, legacy waste remains a challenge. The Economic Survey 2025–26 shows a daily generation of 11,862 tonnes against a capacity of 7,641 tonnes, leaving a gap of about 4,200 tonnes. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

8-yr-old girl drowned after falling into pit

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GURUGRAM: An eight-year-old girl drowned, while her two-year-old sister was rescued safely after they fell into a water-filled pit while playing in a field here on Monday afternoon, police said.

According to the police, the incident took place in the Farrukhnagar area when two sisters, Chhabhi, 8, and Nidhi, 2, while playing, reached a water pit a short distance away in the field and suddenly fell into it, said police. After receiving information, their father, Sunil, who was harvesting wheat in the field, immediately pulled them both out, with the help of bystanders.

The younger daughter, Nidhi, was rescued safely, while the older daughter, Chhabhi, was in critical condition, they said.

People rushed Chhabhi to SGT Hospital, where doctors declared her dead, they added.

Sunil, from Sitapur, worked as a labourer in Sultanpur village. Farukhnagar police said no complaint was filed. The body was handed over after postmortem, and further investigation is underway, a senior officer said.



On sustained questioning, Hariom allegedly confessed to orchestrating the robbery: Police

ning CCTV footage and using technical surveillance.

During the probe, suspicion fell on the servant. On sustained questioning, Hariom allegedly confessed to orchestrating the robbery with his wife, Monika, and his brother-in-law, Sunny Luthra.

Police subsequently conducted raids in Pitampura and Shalimar Bagh, arresting the co-accused from a residence in Pitampura. During searches, Rs 39,97,500 in cash and the bags used in the crime were recovered. Officials said Rs 50,000 from the stolen amount had already been deposited in a bank account.

DAILY MONITORING IN PLACE

No LPG shortage, supply exceeds demand: CM

Government data shows faster deliveries, adequate stock and no need for panic buying

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Amid concerns over fuel availability, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday issued a strong reassurance that LPG supply across the capital remains stable and uninterrupted, urging residents and commercial users to ignore rumours and avoid panic buying as deliveries continue to outpace demand.

Addressing the situation, the Chief Minister said there is no shortage of LPG or any other fuel in Delhi, highlighting that the supply chain is functioning efficiently. “There is no need to panic. LPG supply in Delhi is stable, adequate and fully under control,” she said, appealing to citizens to remain calm and not be influenced by misinformation.

Providing data on domes-



Consumers facing issues in accessing LPG can contact helpline numbers between 9:00 am-7:00 pm PIC/PTI

tic LPG distribution, Gupta noted that on April 12, a total of 1,11,766 bookings were recorded, while Oil Marketing Companies delivered 1,30,094 cylinders, significantly exceeding the demand.

This, she said, reflects effective clearance of pending backlogs and a well-functioning distribution network. She added that the average delivery time has improved from 4.24 days to 3.87 days, ensuring faster

doorstep service.

On the commercial front, Delhi currently has an allocation of 6,480 LPG cylinders (19 kg equivalent) per day. However, the average daily offtake over the past week has been

HIGHLIGHTS

» Providing data on domestic LPG distribution, CM Rekha Gupta noted that on April 12, a total of 1,11,766 bookings were recorded, while Oil Marketing Companies delivered 1,30,094 cylinders, significantly exceeding the demand

» This, she said, reflects effective clearance of pending backlogs and a well-functioning distribution network

only 4,268 cylinders, including 5 kg Free Trade LPG cylinders. “This clearly shows that supply is exceeding demand,” Gupta said, urging commercial users, especially those using smaller cylinders, to avoid unnecessary

stockpiling.

To further assist consumers, a dedicated control room under the Food and Civil Supplies Department is operational. Consumers facing issues in accessing LPG can contact helpline numbers between 9:00 am and 7:00 pm daily.

The government has also encouraged a gradual shift towards alternative fuel sources such as Piped Natural Gas (PNG), particularly for bulk users like hospitals and educational institutions. Additionally, residents have been advised to consider electric or induction cooking as a long-term solution.

Reaffirming the government's commitment, the Chief Minister said authorities are closely monitoring the situation daily to ensure uninterrupted supply across Delhi.

Cops unveil community-based traffic mgmt drive

NEW DELHI: Thousands of e-challans, towing and clamping drives and on-ground traffic improvements have been carried out across parts of Delhi under a new citizen-centric initiative. The action followed the launch of Project ‘SANGAM’ (Synergistic Action and Networked Governance for Area Mobility) by the Delhi Traffic Police earlier this month to address local traffic issues through community participation, according to a statement.

The initiative was rolled out following directions by Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on April 2, who had emphasised the need for involving Resident Wel-

fare Associations (RWAs) and Market Welfare Associations (MWAs) in finding area-specific solutions, it stated.

It said that since April 3, around 30 meetings involving over 6,000 residents have been held in areas such as Connaught Place, Khan Market, Chanakyapuri, Defence Colony, South Extension, Rajouri Garden, Saket and Karol Bagh.

Over 50 suggestions on parking, encroachments and road safety led to intensified enforcement, including e-challans and towing. Authorities also adjusted signal timings, coordinated with civic agencies, and deployed additional staff.

Min Singh outlines subsidies and tax waivers in draft EV Policy 2.0

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh on Monday urged citizens to adopt electric vehicles (EVs) as the government unveiled the Draft Delhi EV Policy 2.0 for public consultation, reinforcing its commitment to a cleaner and more sustainable future.

The draft policy has been placed in the public domain for 30 days, during which citizens and stakeholders can submit suggestions, feedback and objections. The Minister assured that all inputs would be carefully reviewed before finalising the policy. “I appeal to the people of Delhi to adopt EVs. This policy is designed to benefit every citizen while ensuring that no additional financial burden falls on them,” he said.

Highlighting key features, Singh said the policy proposes a comprehensive incentive structure, including purchase subsidies for electric two-



“The policy outlines a phased roadmap for electrification”

wheelers, e-autos and goods vehicles, along with scrapping incentives for older polluting vehicles. It also offers 100% exemption on road tax and registration fees for EVs under specified conditions, aimed at improving affordability.

The policy outlines a phased roadmap for electrification, proposing that only electric three-wheelers will be

registered from January 2027, followed by mandatory electric two-wheelers from April 2028. It also includes a structured plan to transition school bus fleets to electric in the coming years. To support large-scale adoption, the government has planned robust charging infrastructure, with Delhi Transco Limited designated as the nodal agency to develop public charging and battery-swapping stations through a single-window system.

The Minister added that the policy emphasises digital governance, with end-to-end online processes for applications, approvals and subsidy disbursal through direct benefit transfer to ensure transparency.

Expressing confidence in the initiative, Singh said Delhi is well-prepared to meet the rising electricity demand and expects significant EV adoption across segments by 2027, driven by public participation and trust.



received consecutively during the budget session at the Delhi Assembly on March 23-25. All the threats were found to be hoax mails after thorough checks by the police.

“I request you to kindly treat this matter with utmost urgency and trace the source of these emails so that the perpetrators could be brought under law,” Gupta said in his letter to

the police commissioner.

“Further, immediate steps be taken to enhance the security arrangements in and around the Assembly premises to prevent any untoward incident,” he said.

The emails were repeatedly received by the Assembly on its official as well as on his personal email, from various email addresses during the past few weeks, threatening that bombs were planted at the premises, the Speaker said.

“Today also a threatening email has been received at 11.12 am on the official email ID... from ‘gayathri shabaz@hotmail.com,’” Gupta wrote in

his letter to Delhi Police Commissioner Satish Golcha.

The fresh threat mail warned of 15 RDX blasts and cyanide gas use at Assembly premises within three hours, he mentioned in the letter.

The repeatedly received threat e-mails not only hamper the smooth functioning of the Assembly but also instil a sense of fear among the staff working there, the Speaker said.

The Delhi Legislative Assembly is a very important democratic institution and any threat to this institution is very serious matter as it is also a threat to the democratic system, he added.

PWD adopts precast drain tech to revamp Delhi’s drainage network

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Public Works Department (PWD) has begun deploying factory-made precast drains across the city to tackle chronic waterlogging, marking a shift from the conventional cast in-situ method.

PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the move, under the Delhi Drainage Master Plan, will enhance durability and efficiency. Precast drains have an estimated life-

pan of around 50 years, compared to five to six years for cast in-situ structures.

The initiative forms part of a broader strategy to strengthen monsoon preparedness and prevent urban flooding. The master plan, unveiled earlier this year, outlines drainage needs for the next 30 years and assigns roles to departments, with PWD overseeing about 2,152 km of drains.

The technology is being used in several areas, includ-

ing Gyan Shakti Mandir Marg, Chhoturam Marg, Azadpur-Camp Chowk, Sultanpuri, Rohini and Nanangli Road. Officials said precast RCC drains allow faster construction, reduce on-site congestion and improve water flow.

The government has made precast drains mandatory for remodeling projects. By March end, 14 lakh metric tonnes of silt had been removed, with a target of 28 lakh tonnes before the monsoon.

‘Cooperatives, indigenous products key to inclusive growth’

NEW DELHI: Delhi Cooperation Minister Ravinder Indraj Singh on Monday outlined a roadmap to strengthen cooperatives, promote indigenous products and revive traditional arts while addressing the “State Credit Seminar for Delhi” organised by National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development.

During the seminar, the

State Focus Paper for 2026–27 was released, approval letters for Geographical Indication (GI) products were distributed and a digital catalogue showcasing artisans’ products was launched. The event also featured initiatives aimed at financial literacy and skill development.

Addressing stakeholders, the Minister emphasised India’s



strong potential in producing globally competitive goods. He

‘Healthcare sector key as world ages’



OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Monday said that strengthening healthcare and building a skilled workforce will be crucial as ageing populations across the world will lead to a higher demand for medical services in the future.

He was addressing the 71st Founder’s Day celebrations of Sir Ganga Ram Hospital in central Delhi.

“In the coming time, healthcare will be a very important sector, especially as many advanced countries in the world are ageing. Degrees alone are not enough; we need a skill-oriented world. Particularly in the healthcare sector, as countries age, there will be a growing need for assisted healthcare services,” Sandhu said.

He also paid tribute to the hospital’s founder, noting that Sir Ganga Ram was a visionary who combined engineering

excellence with a strong sense of public service. Referring to his role during the Guru ka Bagh Morcha, Sandhu said his contributions reflected moral leadership and a commitment to social responsibility.

In a post on X, the LG described Sir Ganga Ram as a “legendary engineer and visionary philanthropist” whose legacy continues to inspire. He said it was heartening to see the institution uphold these values by balancing clinical excellence with accessible and inclusive healthcare, in line with Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s vision of “Swasth Bharat, Samridh Bharat”.

According to a statement issued by the hospital, the event was attended by senior doctors, faculty members, healthcare professionals and other dignitaries. Addressing the gathering, Dr Ajay Swaroop, chairman, Board of Management, Sir Ganga Ram Hospital, said the institution remains committed to providing quality healthcare across all sections of society and continuing its charitable initiatives.

In 2025–26, the hospital spent Rs 82 crore on free treatment for economically weaker patients. It also received multiple recognitions and will continue focusing on research, biotechnology, medical education and patient care.

Delhi govt to identify Padma Awards nominees by Jun 15

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government on Monday directed officials to identify and recommend desirable and lesser known candidates for the Padma Awards by June 15 for the honours to be announced on Republic Day 2027.

The direction came following a communication from the Ministry of Home Affairs on March 12 inviting nominations for the country’s highest civilian honours -- Padma Vibhushan, Padma Bhushan and Padma Shri.

The ministry said, “It has been observed that in the past that while nominations are received in respect of a large number of persons, there could, however, be several talented persons who are left out of consideration despite exceptional contribution in their field.”

The secretary to CM and ministers here have been asked to send nominations with detailed citations

The city government has also advised that a committee may be constituted to identify and finalise deserving candidates, ensuring that recommendations are based on merit, lifetime achievements and contribution to public service. Officials have been asked to submit nominations with detailed citations via the Rashtriya Puraskar portal, following the prescribed format. Focus is on underrepresented groups. Delhi will process entries till June 15; the final submission deadline is July 31.

PWD plans to renovate ‘jinxed’ Shamnath Marg bungalow

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Public Works Department plans to renovate the long-vacant 33 Shamnath Marg bungalow in Civil Lines, known among officials as “jinxed”.

A tender has been floated for repairs, including ground levelling, false ceiling work, pipeline fixes, tile replacement and parking upgrades, at an estimated cost of Rs 56 lakh. The project is expected to be completed in 30 days, with similar work planned at Lok Niwas Secretariat.

The bungalow housed Delhi’s first chief minister, Chaudhary Brahm Prakash, who resigned before completing his term.

Former chief minister Madan Lal Khurana also did not complete his tenure after being allotted the property. Others, including Shakti Sinha, stayed briefly.

SHIFT FROM ‘BETI BACHAO’ TO ‘BETI BADHAO’

CM Gupta backs women-led dev at Nari Shakti Sammelan

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday said women are now at the centre of decision-making in the country, crediting the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi while addressing the ‘Nari Shakti Vandan Sammelan’ held at Vigyan Bhawan.

Speaking at the conference, attended by several senior leaders and women representatives from across the country, the Chief Minister emphasised the growing role of women in shaping India’s development and global identity. She thanked the Prime Minister for what she described as visionary policies aimed at empowering women. Highlighting the social transformation over the years, Gupta said, “There was a time when even the existence of daughters was under threat. Today, under the Prime Minister’s leadership, the country has



moved beyond ‘Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao’ to an era of ‘Beti Badhao.’ She added that issues such as sati, child marriage, illiteracy and female foeticide, which once hindered women’s progress, are steadily being overcome.

The Chief Minister noted that since 2014, women’s dignity and safety have been prioritised in governance. Referring to initiatives such as the Swachh Bharat Mission, Ujjwala scheme and Jan Dhan Yojana, she said these pro-

grammes have significantly improved the quality of life for women by ensuring sanitation, clean cooking fuel and financial inclusion. She further stated, “Women today are not only advancing in education and nutrition, but are also serving in the armed forces, even flying fighter jets to defend the country.” Citing leaders like Sushma Swaraj and Nir-mala Sitharaman, Gupta said key portfolios held by women underline their growing role in leadership and governance.

“Women today are not only advancing in education and nutrition, but are also serving in the armed forces...”

Describing the ‘Nari Shakti Vandan Act’ as a historic reform, Gupta said, “This will open up leadership opportunities for nearly 700 million women in the country.” She added that the provision of 33 per cent reservation in state assemblies and Parliament will ensure women’s active participation in decision-making.

The Chief Minister also urged women to support the initiative, calling on them to strengthen the vision of women-led development.

Speaker Gupta pays tribute to Jallianwala Bagh martyrs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Marking the 107th anniversary of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre, Delhi Legislative Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta on Monday paid tribute to the martyrs and highlighted a lesser-known episode of British-era brutality in Delhi, describing the Chandni Chowk Clock Tower firing as a precursor to the tragedy in Amritsar.

Paying homage to those who lost their lives in 1919, Gupta said the sacrifices of the martyrs remain a powerful reminder of the atrocities committed during British rule. He emphasised that their courage continues to inspire generations.

Drawing attention to a historical connection with Delhi, the Speaker noted that the present Delhi Legislative Assembly building, then known as the Imperial Legislative Council, witnessed crucial developments in India’s freedom struggle. He said that on March 18, 1919, despite strong opposi-



‘The supreme sacrifices of these martyrs did not go in vain. Their blood ignited the flames of freedom struggle..’

tion from Indian members, the British government passed the Rowlatt Act within this very chamber.

“It was in protest against this act that Mahatma Gandhi called for the Civil Disobedience Movement,” Gupta stated.

He further pointed out that the first spark of resistance emerged in Delhi. Refer-

ring to the incident at Chandni Chowk on March 30, 1919, he said, “Unarmed and innocent citizens who had gathered peacefully were fired upon with machine guns by the British administration,” calling it “a dark chapter in Delhi’s history.”

Gupta added that the events in Delhi were soon followed by the massacre in Amritsar. “This tragic incident at Chandni Chowk was repeated merely fourteen days later, on April 13, 1919, in Amritsar at Jallianwala Bagh, when hundreds of innocent Indians were mercilessly gunned down on the orders of Reginald Dyer,” he said.

Highlighting the significance of the sacrifices, the Speaker said, “The supreme sacrifices of these martyrs did not go in vain. Their blood ignited the flames of the freedom struggle, uniting the nation in the pursuit of independence.”

He concluded by urging citizens to honour their memory and remain committed to building the India they had envisioned.

From Page 1

Tehran says

The blockade threat came after marathon US-Iran ceasefire talks in Pakistan ended without an agreement on Saturday. US Vice President JD Vance said the talks stalled after Iran refused to accept American terms to refrain from developing a nuclear weapon. Iran has demanded compensation for damage caused by US-Israeli strikes that launched the war on Feb 28 and the release of Iran's frozen assets.

Later on Sunday, Trump extended his feud over the war with Pope Leo XIV, lashing out in a Truth Social post that called the Catholic leader "terrible on foreign policy" after Leo denounced the war and demanded that political leaders stop and negotiate peace. The pontiff pushed back Monday, telling reporters that the Vatican's appeals for peace and reconciliation are rooted in the Gospel, and that he doesn't fear the Trump administration.

The blockade is likely intended to pile pressure on Iran, which has exported millions of barrels of oil since the war began, much of it likely carried by so-called "dark" transits that evade Western government sanctions and oversight.

The price of US crude rose 8 per cent to USD 104.24 a barrel following the blockade announcement, and Brent crude oil, the international standard, rose 7 per cent to USD 102.29. Brent crude cost roughly USD 70 per barrel before the war in late February.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu expressed support Monday for Trump's "strong stance to impose a naval blockade on Iran."

Prime Minister Keir Starmer told BBC radio Monday that Britain will not be part of a US blockade of Iranian ports in response to the closing of the Strait of Hormuz and that Britain is "not getting dragged into the war."

A chorus of top-ranking Iranian officials threatened retaliation. Mohsen Rezaei, a military adviser and a former Revolutionary Guard Commander, wrote on X that the country's armed forces had "major untouched levers" to counter a Hormuz blockade.

Iranian parliament speaker, Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf, who led Iran's side in the talks, addressed Trump in a statement on his return to Iran: "If you fight, we will fight."

Iran's Revolutionary Guard later said the Strait remained under Iran's "full control" and was open for non-military vessels, but military ones would get a "forceful response," two semiofficial Iranian news agencies reported.

Vance, who led the US side in the talks in Pakistan, said Washington would need "an affirmative commitment that they will not seek a nuclear weapon."

Iranian officials said talks fell apart over two or three key issues, blaming what they called US overreach. Qalibaf, who noted progress in negotiations, said it was time for the United States "to decide whether it can gain our trust or not."

Neither Iran nor the US indicated what will happen after the ceasefire expires on April 22.

Iran's nuclear program was at the centre of tensions long before the US and Israel launched the war on Feb 28. The fighting has killed at least 3,000 people in Iran, 2,055 in Lebanon, 23 in Israel and more than a dozen in Gulf Arab states, and damaged infrastructure in half a dozen countries.

Tehran has long denied seeking nuclear weapons but insists on its right to a civilian nuclear programme. The landmark 2015 nuclear deal, which Trump later pulled the US out of, took well over a year of negotiations.

Iran ready

is fully prepared for "all options."

"If you want progress in any diplomatic process, (both) sides should be ready for negotiations. And they should avoid unlawful demands," Fathali told a media briefing at the Iranian embassy.

"Our high-ranking officials said we are ready for peace, we are ready for negotiations. But you should know that Iran is also ready for war," he said.

"They wanted to finish the war in three or four days, but the duration, the scope and the geography of the war are under our control. You can see this situation after the 42-day war," he said.

The Iranian ambassador was responding to questions on whether Iran was ready for a new round of talks as the negotiations between the two sides in Islamabad ended without producing any outcome.

The Iranian side had unveiled

some "key points" during the negotiations held in Islamabad, including the nuclear issue, war reparations and relief from sanctions, Fathali said.

When Fathali was asked about the US blockade of Iranian ports, he said the American side is "very well aware of our capacity and capabilities".

"Our high-ranking officials have said they are ready for all options. You can see how in our response and reaction," he said.

The ambassador also asserted that the Strait of Hormuz is part of Iran's "territorial waters". Iran will soon announce a mechanism for using the waterway, he said.

"Iran announced that the Strait of Hormuz is part of the territorial waters of Iran and Oman, and we said that in the near future, we will announce the mechanism for the passage through this strait," Fathali said.

Meanwhile, External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said at a separate media briefing that India is closely following developments in West Asia, including those related to the Strait of Hormuz.

"As we have continuously advocated earlier, de-escalation, dialogue and diplomacy are essential to bring an early end to the conflict. We expect that unimpeded freedom of navigation and global flow of commerce would prevail in the Strait of Hormuz," Jaiswal said.

To a question on whether Indian ships will have to pay a toll for passage through the strait, Fathali did not give a direct reply but said Iran has good relations with India and referred to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's phone conversations with Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on two occasions since the start of the war in West Asia on February 28.

"I believe Iran and India have common interests in the region. I also believe Iran and India have a common fate in the region," he said.

Fathali said the military strikes by Israel and the US have killed 3,753 people, including 887 women and 221 children under the age of 18 since start of the war on February 28.

The attacks also injured more than 30,000, including 4,989 women and 1,979 children, Fathali said, alleging Israel and the US have targeted hospitals, residential settlements, recreational facilities, religious sites, bridges, railway networks and petroleum infrastructure.

Top Court

any opinion, but we would definitely have to apply our minds. Please keep this in mind that the concern of a vigilant voter whose name correctly or incorrectly is not in the list is not in our minds," Justice Bagchi told the Election Commission.

Meanwhile, the Chief Justice of the Calcutta High Court on Monday informed the bench that over 34 lakh appeals had been filed as of April 11, raising concerns over whether 19 appellate tribunals could dispose of them before polling on April 23 and 29 (election dates).

On submission by senior advocate Kalyan Banerjee that all who have filed appeals should be allowed to vote in the two-phase assembly election due later this month, the apex court observed that if excluded persons were granted interim voting rights, similar relief would have to extend to objectors challenging wrongful inclusions. It pointed out that nearly 55 per cent of objections had been rejected, and those appellants could equally seek restraint on such voters.

"If the judicial officers had completed their adjudication in the first instance in respect of any assembly constituency by 9th of April, even if they have exceeded one or two days... we have given the answer. For constituencies whose last date of nomination is 6th of April, the list was published on the night of 6th of April, there was some spill over, those names will be included in the electoral roll for the April 23 election. If their names are there, they can vote," Justice Bagchi said.

Appearing for the state, Senior Advocate Shyam Divan cited the Representation of the People Act, 1950, to argue that existing rolls should prevail if revision remains incomplete. The bench emphasised that pendency of an appeal does not suspend the primary decision, and rules do not permit interim reversal of exclusion.

The court also noted that under Rule 23(5) of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, electoral rolls must be immediately amended if an appeal is allowed, indicating possible recourse to Article 142 (special power of the Supreme Court) to facilitate such corrections without disrupting the process. It cautioned against overburdening tribunals

with unrealistic timelines.

Separately, Justice Bagchi flagged deviations by the Election Commission of India in West Bengal's revision, including the introduction of a "logical discrepancy" category.

Justice Bagchi also stated that the ECI deviated from the stand taken in the Bihar SIR matter that persons who were mapped in the 2002 electoral roll need not upload documents.

Meanwhile, the appellate tribunal at Joka began functioning on Monday with 16 retired judges dealing with the appeals.

PM calls

The government is now seeking to amend the law to enable its rollout from the 2029 Lok Sabha elections. According to official estimates, once implemented, the total strength of the Lok Sabha will rise to 816 seats, with 273 seats reserved for women.

Modi recalled that the legislation received unanimous support across party lines when it was introduced in 2023, and said there had been a shared demand, including from opposition parties, to bring forward its implementation timeline.

"The time to end decades of waiting is now," he said, referring to the upcoming parliamentary sittings where the amendments will be taken up for discussion and passage.

Describing the move as a tribute to women's contributions, the Prime Minister said the decision would rank among the most significant of the century. "It is a decision dedicated to the empowerment of women, a true tribute to the strength and reverence of womanhood," he said.

Highlighting the importance of consensus, Modi said the government aims to carry out the process through dialogue and cooperation. "Our effort and priority is that this work should be accomplished through dialogue, cooperation and participation, which will enhance the dignity of Parliament," he stated.

He also pointed to growing interest among women across the country in participating in legislative roles. According to him, there is a noticeable surge in aspirations among women to enter assemblies and Parliament. He urged women to remain engaged in the process and interact with their elected representatives to share their expectations.

Reflecting on women's contributions to nation-building, Modi referred to their role in the freedom movement and the Constituent Assembly, noting that their participation has been integral to India's development. He added that women holding key constitutional positions today demonstrate their leadership capabilities.

Citing local governance as an example, the Prime Minister said more than 14 lakh women are currently serving in panchayati raj institutions. In about 21 states, their representation in these bodies has reached nearly 50 per cent.

"This active participation of lakhs of women in politics and social life surprises even the world's leading leaders and political experts," he said.

He also referred to studies indicating that higher participation of women in decision-making has led to greater focus on areas such as water supply, education, healthcare and nutrition. The Jal Jeevan Mission, he said, reflects the impact of women's involvement at the grassroots level.

Modi noted that women who have gained experience in local governance are prepared to take on larger responsibilities. "The journey from panchayat to Parliament is going to become easier," he said, adding that timely implementation of the law would open new opportunities.

Reaffirming the government's commitment, he said the aspirations of women are being recognised and addressed through policy measures. He also highlighted initiatives launched since 2014, including Beti Bachao-Beti Padhao, financial assistance of Rs 5,000 under the Matru Vandan Yojana, and the Sukanya Samridhi Yojana aimed at supporting education and welfare of girls.

"The country's Nari Shakti has touched new heights through hard work, courage and self-confidence," Modi said, calling for continued efforts to expand opportunities for women across sectors.

Struggling

past few days, intensified in the Phase 2 industrial area where large groups of workers gathered early in the morning. Officials said around 1,000 workers from multiple companies, including units such as

Motherson, Richa Global, Rainbow, Paramount, SND and Anubhav, joined the protests. Nearly 500 workers assembled outside a Motherson facility, where the situation first turned volatile.

Workers said their demands were rooted in long-standing grievances over wages and working conditions. "We are getting Rs 11,000 to Rs 12,000 a month. How can anyone survive on this in such expensive times," said Raju, a factory worker. He added that daily wages should be at least Rs 800 to Rs 900, but many workers receive only Rs 300 to Rs 400. Another protester said that even after working extended hours, earnings remain insufficient to meet rising costs.

Women workers also voiced concerns about wage disparities and workplace practices. One worker alleged that employees are sometimes made to sign for double shifts but are paid for only a single duty. Others pointed to irregular wage payments and the lack of overtime compensation as per legal norms. "Everything is becoming expensive, but our salaries remain around Rs 11,000-12,000. They should be increased to at least Rs 20,000-25,000," a woman protester said.

A key demand from workers is parity with neighbouring Haryana, where the government recently raised the minimum wage for unskilled workers to Rs 15,220 per month from Rs 11,274.60, with effect from April 1. Protesters also called for minimum monthly wages of at least Rs 15,000 for women and Rs 20,000 for men, along with proper overtime pay, weekly offs and improved workplace facilities.

The protests quickly spread beyond Phase 2 to sectors 60, 62 and 84, as well as other areas including Sectors 1 and 15. Demonstrators blocked National Highway 9 near the Ghaziabad border, a critical artery linking Delhi with western Uttar Pradesh, leading to long traffic snarls. Commuters faced hours-long delays during the morning rush, with queues of vehicles stretching for several kilometres at the Delhi-Noida border.

As tensions escalated, incidents of violence were reported from multiple locations. Protesters set vehicles on fire, including buses and police SUVs, damaged public property and hurled stones. When police attempted to disperse the crowd, a police vehicle was overturned and personnel faced intense stone pelting. Authorities responded by deploying additional forces and using tear gas shells to control the situation.

Police said a heavy deployment has been maintained across industrial zones under the Gautam Buddha Nagar Commissionerate, with senior officers monitoring developments on the ground. "The situation is under control and being continuously monitored. Efforts are being made to counsel the workers and maintain peace. Minimum force is being used wherever necessary," officials said, while appealing to the public not to heed rumours.

In response to the unrest, the Uttar Pradesh government constituted a high-level committee to address the crisis and restore industrial harmony. The panel, chaired by the Industrial Development Commissioner, includes senior officials from the MSME, labour and employment departments, along with representatives from labour unions and industry bodies. The committee has reached Noida and is expected to submit its recommendations on priority after consultations with stakeholders.

Officials said the panel will work towards resolving disputes through dialogue and ensuring smooth industrial operations. They also indicated that a probe would examine whether any vested interests attempted to incite unrest.

The administration had, a day earlier, announced a series of labour welfare measures following meetings with industrial representatives. These include payment of overtime at double the standard rate, a mandatory weekly day off and double wages for work on Sundays. Authorities also said bonuses would be provided as per rules, with payments scheduled by November 30.

Additional directives require factories to ensure timely salary payments by the 10th of each month, issue salary slips and display government guidelines prominently. Units have also been instructed to install complaint boxes, set up internal committees to address workplace issues including sexual harassment and maintain functional CCTV cameras at factory gates.

A control room has been established to handle grievances and maintain coordination, with helpline numbers issued for workers to report concerns. Officials said these measures are aimed at improving transparency and ensuring compliance with labour regulations.

District Magistrate Medha Roopam urged both workers and

employers to maintain dialogue and avoid escalation. She said workers willing to continue their jobs should not face any inconvenience and stressed the need for adherence to government norms.

Uttar Pradesh Minister of State Narendra Kashyap appealed for calm, urging workers to engage with authorities rather than resorting to disruptive actions. "The government is aware of the situation. If there are issues, they should engage with the government, which will work towards resolving them," he said.

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath also addressed the situation, calling on workers to remain cautious of elements that may incite unrest and urging industrialists to maintain direct communication with employees. He said the government remains committed to both worker welfare and industrial security, highlighting measures introduced to ensure direct payment of wages and social security benefits.

Despite assurances, the scale of Monday's unrest has brought attention to the widening gap between wages and living costs for industrial workers in the region. Officials said efforts are ongoing to restore normalcy, with security tightened at key entry points into Delhi and across affected areas in Noida, even as dialogue continues to address the workers' demands.

Workers cry

A woman employed at Motherson said that the situation had become unbearable. "They are paying us less salary. We want more. Cylinders, vegetables and everything are expensive," she said. Recalling the police action during the protest, she added, "I was hit in my legs. I demand that we be paid Rs 20,000 as salary. Only then can we sustain ourselves."

Another protester questioned why workers seeking relief were met with force. "The government had promised to increase our salary. Why isn't the government increasing our wage? Why are the policemen beating women with sticks?" she said.

Manju Devi, who said she works 12-hour shifts, spoke of the strain on her family. "I earn Rs 13,000 a month. How can I raise four children on this salary? How can I feed and educate them?" she asked.

Workers said their daily earnings range between Rs 300 and Rs 400, far below what they need. "Each worker must earn at least Rs 800 a day," one of them said, pointing to rising costs of cooking gas, rent and school fees.

Lakshmi, another protester, said their demands were modest but urgent. "We are just asking for two things, overtime pay and a minimum wage of Rs 20,000 a month. We are being exploited, and there is no safety for women," she said.

Even after the confrontation, workers said they would continue their protest, holding on to the hope that their voices would be heard.

Bihar gears up

BJP parliamentary board and is scheduled to arrive in Patna to oversee the election of the legislature party leader. His presence signals the party's intent to manage the transition closely.

Earlier in the day, Nitish Kumar, who leads the Janata Dal (United), is set to convene what is likely to be his final cabinet meeting at 11 am. During the meeting, he is expected to formally communicate his decision to dissolve the cabinet before proceeding to submit his resignation to the Governor. "It is a constitutional requirement. The chief minister informs his colleagues about his decision to dissolve the cabinet and goes to the Governor with the recommendation," said minister Dilip Jaiswal.

Kumar's move comes weeks after he surprised political observers by announcing his intention to enter the Rajya Sabha. The 75-year-old leader, the longest-serving chief minister of the state, had recently led the NDA to a decisive victory in the November assembly elections.

Attention has now turned to who will replace him. Deputy Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary has emerged as a leading contender, although the BJP has not made any official announcement. Choudhary, who represents the Tarapur assembly constituency, has seen increased political activity around him, with several senior leaders visiting his residence on Monday.

Among those who called on him were Sanjay Saraogi and JD(U) national working president Sanjay Kumar Jha. In a development that added to speculation, a vehicle from the Governor's secretariat was also seen entering his residence at 5, Desh Ratna Marg later in the afternoon.

Choudhary's political journey includes nearly two decades in the Rashtriya Janata Dal before he joined the BJP in 2017. Despite being relatively new to the party, he is believed to enjoy the confidence of Nitish Kumar, whose JD(U) remains a crucial ally in the NDA. His social background is also viewed as politically significant. Belonging to the Koeri community, one of Bihar's largest Other Backward Classes groups, he is seen as capable of strengthening the NDA's support base.

The JD(U), which holds 85 seats in the 243-member assembly, slightly trails the BJP's tally by four seats. Party workers appeared to be preparing for the transition, with posters celebrating Nitish Kumar's leadership being taken down at the party office. Some leaders expressed hope that Kumar's son, Nishant, who recently joined the party, could find a place in the new cabinet, possibly as a deputy chief minister.

The leadership change could mark a significant moment for the BJP, which has not had its own chief minister in Bihar despite being a dominant force in the Hindi heartland. However, not all within the party are convinced about Choudhary's elevation. Some leaders have pointed to alternatives such as Union Minister of State for Home Nityanand Rai, noting his long-standing association with the Sangh.

There is also speculation that the party leadership could opt for an unexpected choice, as seen in states like Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh where relatively lesser-known figures were picked for the top post.

Adding a note of caution, Trinamool Congress MP Shatrughan Sinha recently remarked that Bihar has "plenty of deserving people" but warned of surprises, referring to instances where leadership decisions were made through last-minute selections.

Monsoon

Retail inflation stood at 3.4 per cent in March, but analysts warn it could rise above 4.5 per cent during the fiscal year. India's growth is currently projected at 6.8 to 7.2 per cent, though risks remain tied to weather patterns and global uncertainties.

ED arrests I-PAC

The ED alleged that Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee obstructed its searches and tampered with evidence, while the TMC chairperson countered that the agency was attempting to seize her party's sensitive election-strategy documents ahead of the Assembly polls.

Banerjee also alleged that the ED's actions were aimed at targeting I-PAC, which works for the TMC, in an attempt to access and misuse the party's data.

The TMC supremo had said: ED raided my IT sector (cell) office and searched the residence of the person in charge of my IT sector (cell). They were confiscating my party's documents and hard disks, which had details about our party candidates for the Assembly polls. I have brought those back."

Meanwhile, the arrest, on Monday, comes more than a week after the agency launched fresh raids on I-PAC on April 2, including Chandel's residence, and the premises of another director, Rishi Raj Singh and former communications in-charge of Aam Aadmi Party, Vijay Nair.

Officials reportedly said that Chandel was taken into custody from Delhi under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act PMLA and will be produced before a court on Tuesday.

ED, reportedly, has alleged that around Rs 20 crore proceeds of crime generated in the West Bengal coal mining racket were transferred through hawala channels to I-PAC.

ED's money laundering probe is based on a Central Bureau of Investigation's FIR of 2020 on allegations that coal was illegally mined at Eastern Coalfields Ltd's mines in Kunustoria and Kajora in West Bengal.

The agency had earlier questioned TMC national general secretary and MP Abhishek Banerjee, alleging he was a beneficiary of funds from the illegal mining.

I-PAC, in a statement in January, claimed that its role is limited to transparent, professional political consulting, free of influence from political ideology.

"We believe this [the raids] raises serious concerns and sets an unsettling precedent. Regardless, we have extended full cooperation... engaging with the process in complete accordance and respect for the law," the statement

added.

Reacting to the development on X, Abhishek Banerjee said: "The arrest of Vinesh Chandel, co-founder of I-PAC, barely 10 days before the Bengal elections, is not just alarming- It shakes the very idea of a level playing field.

At a time when WB should be moving toward free and fair elections, this kind of action sends a chilling message: If you work with the opposition, you could be next. That's not democracy- that's intimidation!

What makes it even harder to ignore is the double standard. Those facing serious corruption allegations seem to find protection the moment they switch sides, while others are swiftly targeted at politically convenient moments. People are not blind to this anymore.

When institutions meant to protect democracy start feeling like tools of pressure, trust begins to erode. On one side, the Election Commission. On the other, agencies like the ED, NIA, CBI stepping in at the most sensitive time. It creates an atmosphere of fear, not fairness.

India has always taken pride in its democracy- loud, messy but free. But today, many are beginning to ask: are we still that country?

This is bigger than one arrest. It is about whether our institutions remain independent and whether every citizen, no matter their political belief, can participate without fear.

Because once fear replaces freedom, democracy becomes just a word.

To Amit Shah and the BJP's power structure- Be in Bengal on the 4th and 5th of May. Come with Gyanesh Kumar and every agency you deploy. Bengal will not be bullied, will not be silenced and will not bow. This is a land that answers pressure with resistance and it will show you exactly what that means!"

Twin road

crashed into the oncoming truck. Officials said all occupants of the vehicle, including the driver, were killed. The victims included eight men and three women.

Murbad Tehsildar Abhijit Deshmukh said the impact left the van completely mangled. "The occupants were crushed inside," he said, adding that the bodies were moved to the Goveli primary health centre for post-mortem examinations.

State Transport Minister Pratap Sarnaik said the vehicle, authorised to carry six passengers, had 11 people on board. He urged commuters to avoid travelling in overloaded vehicles and called for greater public awareness around road safety. Local residents said one side of the road was closed due to ongoing construction, forcing traffic into a single lane. They also alleged that such van services routinely operate beyond permitted capacity, charging between Rs 70 and Rs 100 per seat.

Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis described the crash as "extremely tragic", while Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde offered condolences and said a detailed probe would be conducted. Police have registered a case and are examining the circumstances that led to the collision.

In a separate incident in Gujarat's Surendranagar district, seven people were killed and four others injured after a speeding truck ran over a group of pilgrims in the early hours of Monday. The accident occurred around 1.30 am on the Lakhtar-Viramgam highway near Bhaskarpura village.

Police said the victims were part of a group of around 500 devotees walking from Rajkot to Bahucharaji to offer prayers at a temple. The group was heading towards Chharad village for a night halt when the truck, loaded with cotton, struck them from behind as they attempted to pass a stationary dumper on the roadside.

Six people died on the spot, while another succumbed to injuries at a hospital in Viramgam. The deceased included four women. Officials said three of the injured sustained minor wounds, while one person was referred to a hospital in Rajkot for further treatment.

"The truck was coming at full speed from behind when it hit the pilgrims," said a police official, adding that the driver fled the scene but was later taken into custody. Authorities have launched an investigation into the incident.

Both accidents have drawn attention to road safety concerns, including overloading, speeding and inadequate traffic management, as officials continue to probe the causes.





SONIA GANDHI ALSO CLAIMS IT AS AN 'ASSAULT' ON THE CONSTITUTION ITSELF

‘Govt’s proposed delimitation extremely dangerous’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress Parliamentary Party chairperson Sonia Gandhi on Monday asserted the real issue with the government’s move to bring Bills in a special sitting of Parliament this week is delimitation, not women’s reservation, and claimed the reported delimitation proposal is “extremely dangerous” as well as an “assault” on the Constitution itself.

Gandhi stressed that any delimitation involving an increase in the strength of the Lok Sabha must be politically, and not just arithmetically, equitable.

In an article published in The Hindu, she also alleged that Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s real intention now is to further “delay and derail” the caste census.

Prime Minister Modi is making appeals to Opposition parties to support Bills that the government wants to “bulldoze” through Parliament in a “special session” when the election campaign in Tamil Nadu and West Bengal will be at its peak,



Sonia Gandhi

she said.

“There can be only one reason for the extraordinary hurry, which is to derive political advantage and place the Opposition on the defensive,” she alleged.

The Prime Minister is, as usual, being economical with the truth, Gandhi claimed.

Tagging Gandhi’s article, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi said she has written about how the real concern in the important process of women’s reservation are

Highlights

- » Gandhi stressed that any delimitation involving an increase in the strength of the Lok Sabha must be politically, and not just arithmetically, equitable
- » Gandhi also alleged that PM Modi’s real intention now is to further ‘delay and derail’ the caste census

the risks and inequities posed by a “rushed delimitation”.

Noting that Parliament passed the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, 2023 unanimously in September 2023 during a special session, Sonia Gandhi said the law introduced Article 334-A in the Constitution which mandated one-third reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabhas, scheduled to come into effect after the completion of the next Census and the Census-based delimitation process.

‘Oppn parties meeting on April 15 to discuss women’s reservation’

BENGALURU: Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Monday said the Congress will convene a meeting of all the opposition parties on April 15 to deliberate on the implementation of the Women’s Reservation law, accusing the Centre of not being prepared to hold a comprehensive consultation with all stakeholders.

Addressing reporters here, he maintained that while the party fully supports the legislation, there is a need for wide discussions on its implementation given its broader national implications.

“The Centre has called a meeting. I have already replied to the letter written either by Kiren Rijiju or even the Prime Minister to me,” Kharge said.

MPOST

down, Sonia Gandhi said.

“Instead, the prime minister has resorted to writing op-eds, making appeals to political parties, and organising sammelans. It is an underhand tactic that reflects the prime minister’s one-upmanship and his ‘my way or the highway’ approach to decision-making,” she said.

Gandhi also said The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, 2023 stands on the shoulders of the achievement of the 73rd and the 74th Constitution Amendment Bills following whose passage reservation for women in panchayats and nagarpalikas became a law.

“The last decadal Census was due in 2021. The Modi government kept postponing it. One consequence of this has been that over 10 crore people have been deprived of their legal entitlements under the National Food Security Act, 2013 that provides the basis for the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana,” she said.

Gandhi further noted that Census operations have begun only after an inexplicable delay of five years.

Modi: Under PM Awas Yojana, over 3 cr women become homeowners

‘To empower women, its essential to increase their economic participation’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday asserted that financial empowerment has given greater say in family affairs to women who have been traditionally sidelined, quipping he may not be into “family life” (grihasth) but is aware of its dynamics.

Addressing a women’s conference, the Prime Minister said everyone is well aware that to empower women in India, it is essential to increase their economic participation, and hence his government kept this aspect in mind in every decision and scheme it rolled out.

“Earlier, family property was primarily held in the names of men. If there was a house, it was in the man’s name; a farm land, in the man’s name; a shop, in the man’s name; a car, in the man’s name; even a scooter was in the man’s name, and this was considered nat-



PM Narendra Modi

ural. Under the ‘PM Awas Yojana,’ we began prioritising the registration of houses in the names of the women of the household,” he said.

In the past 11 years, more than three crore women have become homeowners due to this initiative. “Because of this, women are becoming economically empowered within their households,” he said.

Referring to normal household affairs, the PM said, “Usually when a father and son talk about business, if the mother brings tea and stands there for a while, they say, ‘You go back to the kitchen, we are talking.’”

Shah: SIR ‘major issue’ in Bengal, people firm on throwing infiltrators out

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Union Home minister Amit Shah on Monday stated that the people of West Bengal will reply to bombs with votes on EVMs during the Assembly polls and are determined to throw infiltrators out, while asserting that the BJP will definitely form the government in the state.

Acknowledging that the SIR of voters’ list is a “major issue” in the state polls, Shah, during his end-of-the-day roadshow in Durgapur, told news agency that the responsibility for political violence in Bengal lies only with Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee and her nephew, Abhishek Banerjee, who is the TMC’s general secretary.

Earlier, while addressing a crowd in Paschim Bardhaman’s Ranigunj, the home minister said Mamata Banerjee and Aam Janata Unnayan Party chief Humayun Kabir are “two of a kind”, and the BJP will never allow a Babri Masjid to be built in Bengal if it wins the Assembly elections.

“The BJP would definitely form a govt in Bengal after the polls. This is the only region left in the country where political violence is most commonplace, and the responsibility for that lies only with Mamata Banerjee and Abhishek Banerjee,”



Union Home minister Amit Shah addresses the gathering during an election campaign rally, at Kotasur in Birbhum district, Monday PTI

Shah said during his Durgapur roadshow.

“SIR is indeed a major issue for West Bengal. Should there be foreign voters in this country? India is not a ‘dharamsala’ (charitable home). Infiltrators must be thrown out. No matter what Mamata Banerjee says, people have resolved to remove infiltrators from the state this time,” he added.

Addressing a poll rally at Mayureshwar in Birbhum district, Shah said the BJP will “end mafia raj” in the state after winning the polls.

“People of Bengal have decided to bid goodbye to the Mamata Banerjee government; they will reply to bombs and bullets with votes,” he said.

HEAVY FOOTFALL SEEN ON ITS FIRST DAY

Special tribunal on voter list deletions starts functioning

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: A special judicial tribunal set up at the Joka Shyama Prasad Institute began functioning on Monday following a Supreme Court directive to address complaints related to the deletion of names from electoral rolls.

The tribunal witnessed heavy footfall on its first day, with several people whose names were removed from the voter list arriving since morning to file applications and seek redressal, an official stated.

A total of 16 out of 19 appointed judges began work on the opening day, examining received applications and undertaking preliminary scrutiny of documents to assess the validity of the complaints.

“We are examining each application carefully at the initial stage to verify the merit of the claims,” a tribunal official reportedly said, adding that cases involving discrepancies or incomplete information would be taken up for further hearing.

Under the procedure, applicants may be called in person if any confusion or inconsistency is found in their submissions, and matters will be

The Tribunal

- » A total of 16 out of 19 appointed judges began work on the opening day, examining received applications and -undertaking preliminary scrutiny of documents to assess the validity of the complaints
- » ‘We are examining each application carefully at the initial stage to verify the merit of the claims’

settled through hearings wherever required.

Several applicants expressed hope that the tribunal would help restore their names in the electoral rolls. “I have come here to ensure my name is brought back to the voter list so that I can exercise my right to vote,” a petitioner waiting outside the premises reportedly said.

Officials were learnt to have said that the mechanism has been introduced to ensure swift and fair disposal of grievances related to voter list deletions in line with the apex court’s direction.

Nation Remembers
The Architect of the Indian Constitution
Babasaheb Dr. Bhimrao Ambedkar ji
on his Birth Anniversary
April 14, 2026

Information, Public Relations & Languages Department, Haryana
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ABHI NA JAAO CHHODKAR...

Sorrow and song as Asha Bhosle cremated with full state honours

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: “Abhi Na Jao Chhodkar...” The strains of that wistful song played in the background at the Shivaji Park crematorium on Monday as hundreds of people gathered inside -- and outside -- to bid music legend Asha Bhosle a final sayonara.

A gun salute rang out as the last rites of Bhosle, perhaps the last of the singing greats who ruled the soundwaves for decades and still do, were held in accordance with Hindu rituals and with full state honours. Her son Anand performed the rituals.

Bhosle, one half of the legendary Mangeshkar sisters, passed away on Sunday due to multi-organ failure. She was 92 as was her Lata didi when she died in February 2022.

Priests recited mantras around the funeral pyre, decorated with vibrant yellow and orange marigolds.

Granddaughter Zana was inconsolable. Sister Usha Mangeshkar, also a singer, and brother Hridaynath Mangeshkar, a music composer, were there too.

Among those gathered to pay their last respects to India's singer nonpareil were Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, Deputy Chief Ministers Eknath Shinde and Sunetra Pawar, director Ramesh Sippy and actors Aamir Khan



Police personnel and family members carry the mortal remains of Asha Bhosle during her last rites at a crematorium, in Mumbai, Monday

PTI

and Vicky Kaushal.

It was a moment of sorrow and song too.

Before the pyre was lit, singers Shaan, Sudesh Bhosle and Anup Jalota paid a musical tribute to the enduring legend who sang some 12,000 songs in an incredible eight-decade career that started when she was just 10.

While Sudesh Bhosle crooned “Zindagi Ek Safar Hai Suhana”, Shaan sang “Pyaar Ke Mod Pe”.

And they were not the only ones.

Many fans, their hands folded in prayer, were heard

HIGHLIGHTS

» Bhosle, one half of the legendary Mangeshkar sisters, passed away on Sunday due to multi-organ failure

» She was 92 as was her Lata didi when she died in February 2022

singing the many numbers that made Bhosle the star that she was for music lovers of all ages and through many generations.

Snatches of “Aaiye Meherbaan”, the languid song

of love filmed on Madhubala, and “Chura Liya Hai Tumne Jo Dil Pe”, romance of another hue pictured on Zeenat Aman many decades later, and many others, could be heard. Some softly crooned, others louder.

“I’ve been a huge fan of Asha Tai. She has had songs for every mood and occasion. Our Tai, and her songs, will live forever in our hearts,” said one ardent fan.

The irrepressible, exuberance of the versatile Bhosle, who was compelling whether she was singing classical or cabaret, was inspirational, said another.

light on Monday. Reports said the attacker slit her throat before she could resist.

Governor Shiv Pratap Shukla condemned the incident as “heinous and unacceptable” and directed Director General of Police Ashok Tewari to ensure prompt action. The Himachal Pradesh Commission for Women also sought strict mea-

sures, with its chairperson Vidya Negi reviewing the case with local police. Opposition leader Jai-ram Thakur termed the incident shocking, alleging a decline in law and order and failure to ensure women's safety. The Students Federation of India staged protests at Himachal Pradesh University, linking the crime to the growing drug menace.

Mandi: College girl killed in broad daylight

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SHIMLA: The daylight murder of a 19-year-old college student at Sarkaghat in Himachal Pradesh's Mandi has triggered outrage across the state, with authorities promising swift action and protests erupting over safety concerns.

Siya, a first-year BBA stu-

She was on her way to college when she was attacked by 2 bike-borne assailants

dent, was on her way to college for exams when she was allegedly attacked by two bike-borne assailants and killed in broad day-

Haryana: Civic polls in Ambala, Panchkula & Sonipat on May 10

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana State Election Commission on Monday announced that elections for Panchkula, Ambala and Sonipat municipal corporations and other municipal bodies and panchayati raj institutions will be conducted on May 10.

The votes will be counted on May 13.

Announcing the election schedule, State Election Commissioner Devinder Singh Kalyan said the Model Code of Conduct has come into immediate effect in the poll-bound areas.

As per the announcement, elections will be held for the selection of mayors and councilors of Ambala, Panchkula and

INSIGHT

» The votes will be counted on May 13

» The Model Code of Conduct has come into immediate effect

Sonipat municipal corporations, as well as the president and ward members of Rewari municipal council and the municipal committees of Sampla, Dharuhera and Uklana.

Additionally, by-elections will be conducted for six vacant ward member seats in municipal councils/committees of Tohana, Jhajjar, Rajound, Tarawadi, Kanina and Sadhaura.

Under the panchayati raj institutions, elections will be

held in gram panchayats of Mandi Adampur and Jawahar Nagar in Hisar, and Govindpura and Polad in Kaithal.

By-elections will be conducted for 528 vacant posts -- including for panch, sarpanch, panchayat samiti and zila parishad members -- across the state.

With the Model Code of Conduct coming into effect from April 13, the transfer of officials and other employees in the poll-bound areas has been restricted until completion of the election process.

The main contest in the municipal elections is expected between the Congress and the ruling BJP. At present, the mayor posts in all three municipal corporations going to polls are held by the BJP.

NCC launches cyber security training programme for cadets

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The National Cadet Corps (NCC) has launched a nationwide Cyber Security Capacity Building Programme in collaboration with the National Institute of Electronics and Information Technology (NIELIT).

The initiative, formalised through a Memorandum of Understanding, aims to equip NCC cadets with essential digital skills, cyber hygiene practices and hands-on defence training. It was launched in the presence of DG NCC Lt Gen Virendra Vats and DG NIELIT Madan Mohan Tripathi.

The programme will be rolled out in two phases. The first phase comprises a 15-hour online Cyber Security Awareness Programme, covering digital literacy, safe internet use and identification of cyber threats. It will be accessible to all NCC cadets through NIELIT's Digital University platform.

The second phase, a 60-hour Cyber Defender Programme, will offer advanced



The initiative seeks to create a cadre of trained ‘Cyber Cadets’ to promote digital safety

offline training to selected cadets based on merit, focusing on simulations and practical tools to tackle cyber threats.

The initiative seeks to create a cadre of trained “Cyber Cadets” to promote digital safety and support grassroots cyber security efforts, aligning with the broader goals of Digital India and skill development frameworks.

Punjab passes anti-sacrilege Bill

Passed during special session, it proposes life imprisonment, heavy fines

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: The Punjab Assembly on Monday unanimously passed a Bill proposing stricter punishment, including life imprisonment and a fine up to Rs 25 lakh, for any act of sacrilege against the Guru Granth Sahib.

Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann presented the Jaagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar (Amendment) Bill, 2026, during a special session of the Assembly here.

The AAP government convened a special session of the Vidhan Sabha to amend the Jaagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar Act, 2008, for stricter punishment against sacrilege of the Guru Granth Sahib.

After the bill was passed, Mann thanked the members of the House for supporting the Bill and said it would act as a strong deterrent against acts of sacrilege.

Mann also said the bill does not need to be sent to the President, adding that it requires only the Governor's assent.

The Jaagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar (Amend-



ment) Bill, 2026, proposes stricter punishments to deter incidents of ‘beadbi’ (sacrilege) and uphold the sanctity of the Guru Granth Sahib.

According to the bill, any person who commits an offence of sacrilege of the ‘Saroop(s)’ (sacred scripture) of the Guru Granth Sahib under this Act shall be punished with imprisonment of either description for a term which shall not be less than seven years but which may extend to 20 years.

There shall also be a fine which shall not be less than Rs 2 lakh but which may extend to Rs 10 lakh.

Any person, who in criminal conspiracy, commits sacri-

the India-UAE Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.”

Minister for External Affairs S. Jaishankar paid a visit to the United Arab Emirates, meeting with its leaders and members of the Indian diaspora. On the first day of his visit, the EAM met with the Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister of the UAE, Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan, who discussed the changing dynamics in the region, while India appreciated the UAE's support for Indians.

As part of a broader diplomatic push, Minister for Petroleum and Natural Gas Hardeep Singh Puri, also, recently visited Qatar, while Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal has been in touch with counterparts across the Gulf region.

According to the Ministry of External Affairs, all Indian missions and posts in West Asia

continue to maintain high alert and coordinate closely with the Indian community there through continuous advice to them. Help lines run 24 hours a day and missions have been coordinating closely with local administrations for help to Indians, including crew members of Indian ships.

Moreover, the government has coordinated with state governments and union territories to improve their responsiveness towards Indians abroad. Meanwhile, the MEA spokesperson also informed that travel by air is ongoing, though with certain limitations in some regions. From February 28 onwards, almost 9.27 lakh passengers have flown from the region to India, Jaiswal said.

Approximately 100 commercial, scheduled flights are likely to fly in the UAE based

on safety grounds. The flights from Saudi Arabia and Oman are operational, and those in Qatar are partially operational.

Nevertheless, there are some limitations in certain countries. Airspace in Kuwait is closed, and travel arrangements can be made via Saudi Arabia. Likewise, Indian citizens in Bahrain can arrange their travel via Saudi Arabia, but partial operations may commence soon.

As many as 2,200 Indian nationals have been helped by the Indian embassy in Tehran to move to Armenia and Azerbaijan, from where they can return to India, MEA informed. The Indian embassy in Tel Aviv is making arrangements for their travel from Israel via Jordan and Egypt. In addition, travel arrangements for Indians leaving Iraq are being made through different channels.

Assam govt moves Apex Court against anticipatory bail to Cong leader Kherra

State govt's petition likely to be taken up for hearing this week

MPOST BUREAU

Cong stands with Pawan Kherra: Rahul

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Monday said his party stands with Pawan Kherra and “will not be intimidated”, after the Assam government moved the Supreme Court challenging the transit anticipatory bail to him in a case related to his allegations against Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma and his wife.

In a post on X, Gandhi

alleged: “The present CM of Assam is the most corrupt in the country. He will not escape the law. His abuse of state power to harass his political opponents and critics is against the Constitution.”

“The questions that are being raised have to be probed. Transparency, accountability of power and rule of law are the basis of our Constitutional values. The Congress Party stands with Pawan Kherra. We will not be intimidated,” he said.

case, this court is of the view that the petitioner has made out a case for grant of limited transit anticipatory bail, as his apprehension of arrest appears to be reasonable and supported by material on record,”

the High Court had said in its order.

The conditions were that the petitioner shall be released on bail in the event of arrest on his executing a personal bond for Rs one lakh with two

sureties for the like sum each, cooperate with the investigation and make himself available for interrogation as and when required by the Investigating Officer and that he shall not leave the country without prior permission of the competent Court.

The Congress leader on April 5 had alleged that the Assam CM's wife, Riniki Bhuyan Sarma, has multiple passports and foreign property, which were not declared in the CM's election affidavit for the April 9 Assembly polls.

The case against Kherra was registered at the Guwahati Crime Branch Police Station under several sections of the BNS, including 175 (false statement in connection with an election), 35 (Right of private defence of the body and of property) and 318 (cheating).

Haryana CM says govt committed to promoting teachings of Sikh Gurus

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday said that both the central and state governments are continuously working to take the principles and teachings of the Sikh Gurus to every section of society.

Addressing a gathering as chief guest at the state-level Baisakhi Mahotsav 2026 organised by the Art and Cultural Affairs Department in collaboration with the district administration at Kurukshetra, Saini said that India is progressing towards a new era under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and is moving rapidly towards the goal of ‘Viksit Bharat 2047’.

He emphasised that the teachings of the Sikh Gurus -- unity, dedication, service and hard work -- must be adopted in daily life to build an inclu-



rious history.

Recalling the historical importance of the day, he said that on this day in 1699, at Sri Anandpur Sahib, the tenth Sikh Guru, Guru Gobind Singh, established the Khalsa Panth at a time when injustice and oppression were at their peak, giving a new direction to society based on courage, equality, self-respect and patriotism.

Extending greetings on the auspicious occasion of Baisakhi, Saini paid obeisance to the revered Gurus on the foundation day of the Khalsa Panth. He also inaugurated an exhibition based on Sikh history as well as the achievements and schemes of the state government. Saini also flagged off wrestling competitions for men and women and inaugurated the international kite competition.

MPOST

CBI arrests accused in 2014 abduction case

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Monday arrested a long-absconding accused in connection with a 2014 kidnapping case involving the disappearance of two persons from Kolkata, officials said.

The accused, identified as Bhola Singh, also known by aliases Gautam Kumar and Amit Sharma, was apprehended from a hideout in Surat after sustained surveillance and coordinated efforts by investigating teams. The case had been referred to the CBI following judicial intervention, and Singh had been evading arrest since the probe began in 2015.

Investigators said Singh allegedly used forged documents and false identities to remain undetected for years. His arrest came after specific intelligence inputs helped trace his location, leading to a carefully planned operation to confirm and secure his presence.

Officials revealed that Singh is also wanted in at least 11 criminal cases registered by Bihar Police, including serious charges such as abduction, attempted murder and alleged links to homicide. Records also indicate involvement in illegal possession of arms and explosives.

Following his arrest, Singh was produced before a court in Surat for transit remand. He will be taken to Kolkata under legal escort and produced before a magistrate for further proceedings in the kidnapping case.

MPOST

Nation Briefs

NFR DEVELOPS ‘ZUBEEN GARG’ RAILWAY BIHUTOLI AT MALIGAON

MALIGAON: The Northeast Frontier Railway has developed a new ‘Bihutoli’, a cultural ground for celebrating Bihu and other important cultural events, at Maligaon.



In a heartfelt tribute to celebrate Assamese singer Zubeen Garg, it has been named as ‘Zubeen Garg Railway Bihutoli’, reflecting the deep cultural connect and admiration for the artist across Assam. The Bihutoli has been developed with various modern facilities, including a permanent stage area, dining hall, toilet complex, community space, boundary wall and an all-weather ground.

UP: NHRC TO HOLD VIRTUAL HEARING ON 216 BONDED LABOUR CASES ON APRIL 16

NEW DELHI: The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) will hold an online hearing on April 16 to review 216 cases of alleged bonded labour in brick kilns across several districts of Uttar Pradesh. Despite being conducted virtually, the proceedings will allow for comprehensive legal scrutiny. Officials said no physical appearance is required, but established protocols will be strictly followed. Each case will be examined in line with national labour laws, and hearings will conclude only after all relevant documents are formally placed on record.



EDITORIAL

ELECTORAL
SCRUTINY

The Supreme Court's recent observations on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in West Bengal bring into focus a troubling fault line in India's electoral machinery—one that lies between procedural correctness and the fundamental right to vote. When the Court remarked that the Election Commission of India (ECI) had created a "logical discrepancy" list only during the revision process, it was not merely pointing to an administrative inconsistency. It was highlighting a deeper institutional dilemma: when systems designed to ensure electoral purity end up risking exclusion, democracy itself is placed under strain.

At the heart of the issue is the uneasy position of the voter, "sandwiched" between constitutional authorities, as Justice Joymalaya Bagchi observed. The ECI's argument that a large number of rejections were upheld by judicial officers may suggest procedural validation, but it does not settle the question of fairness. The Court's reminder that "means must justify the end" is significant. Electoral integrity cannot come at the cost of arbitrary or inconsistent processes, especially when they affect citizens' participation in democracy.

The controversy surrounding the "logical discrepancy" list further complicates matters. If earlier assurances suggested that those on the 2002 electoral rolls need not furnish fresh documentation, then a shift in approach—requiring proof of identity linked to that list—raises legitimate concerns about transparency and consistency. Judicial scrutiny, in this context, becomes not an obstacle but a safeguard, ensuring that administrative improvisations do not undermine established principles.

Equally important is the acknowledgment of human limitations in adjudication. Justice Bagchi's candid observation about error margins in large-scale document scrutiny underscores the need for a robust appellate mechanism. In a process as sensitive as voter verification, even small errors can have disproportionate consequences. The absence or delay of effective appellate remedies risks compounding these errors, leaving citizens disenfranchised without timely recourse. Ultimately, the Court's emphasis on the right to vote as not merely constitutional but also "sentimental" is a powerful reminder. Voting is more than a procedural act; it is a citizen's affirmation of belonging in a democratic system. As electoral processes grow more complex, institutions must ensure that efficiency does not eclipse inclusion. The challenge is not just to maintain clean electoral rolls, but to do so in a manner that strengthens, rather than weakens, public trust in democracy.

FLASHPOINT
ASIA



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS
A RETIRED IPS
OFFICER, ADVISER
NATSTRAT, AND A
FORMER NATIONAL
SECURITY ADVISOR
IN MAURITIUS

Drawing strength
from the US and
using a militarist
tenor against
India might prove
counterproductive
to Pakistan

Amid shifting geopolitics, Pakistan's aggressive posturing towards India exposes deeper
insecurities and threatens to destabilise an already volatile regional security environment

Pakistan is seen to be doing hectic diplomacy in trying to mediate between Iran and the US for the de-escalation of the ongoing military conflict. However, it appears this is not happening, and there are conflicting signals from Iran regarding participation in the mediation. Things are looking uncertain and fluid. Under these circumstances, an outburst (April 4) from Pakistani Defence Minister Khawaja Asif targeting India speaks of outright belligerence and a threatened misadventure. This is most unbecoming of a Defence Minister when the world is in turmoil due to the war in Iran. Khawaja Asif was categorical in saying that any future conflict with India would not be confined to the border and could possibly reach deep inside India, naming Kolkata as the potential target. Further, Asif did not stop at Kolkata and, raising the pitch, said the next round of conflict will force India to face even greater "humiliation" than last year, implying Operation Sindoor. He said that this time, the conflict will not remain limited to 200-250 km, and Pakistan will enter their (India's) territory and strike them inside their own homes. These aggressive and bizarre remarks reflect earlier warnings from Pakistan about expanding the theatre of conflict towards the east.

It needs recapitulation that Chief of Defence Forces (CDF) Asim Munir, during his stay in the US, spoke on similar lines, threatening to extend the war to the Eastern theatre while speaking (August 10, 2025) before a section of the Pakistani dias-



From threats to terror links, Islamabad's posture reflects a dangerous mix of aggression and instability

pora in Tampa, Florida. He also threatened to use the nuclear arsenal for this. Here, Munir's tenor was more acrimonious, aggressive, and clearly posturing with war-like hysterics. His threat to plunge the region into nuclear war, should his country face an existential threat, saying "we are a nuclear nation; if we think we are going down, we will take half the world down with us" is alarming. Pakistan Defence Minister's recent comments, very threatening in nature at this juncture, cannot be dismissed lightly, and they echo Munir's aggressive rhetoric.

Studying such threats, first by Munir and now by the Defence Minister, focusing on India's Eastern flank, a pattern seems to emerge: a systematic, periodic issuance of threats from so-called responsible quarters. This implies that Pakistan continues to be on its mischief trail not only in order

to prick India but also to address its domestic constituency about its self-proclaimed military jingoism, as also to reiterate the false notion that it had "outclassed" India in last year's military conflict leading to Operation Sindoor.

It may also be recalled that this month, on April 22, we observe the Pahalgaon massacre carried out by Pakistan. Preceding this, on April 16, 2025, Asim Munir had addressed a group of non-resident Pakistanis in Islamabad in the presence of Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, where he had said that Pakistan's enemies are mistaken in thinking that a handful of terrorists can dictate the country's destiny. He had underscored that even ten generations of terrorists cannot damage Baluchistan or Pakistan, adding that Baluchistan is not only vital to the country's future but also a symbol of national pride. In the same vein, Munir had touched

upon the "two-nation theory" and made acerbically divisive remarks. Khawaja Asif's latest remarks are more or less on similar lines.

Meanwhile, dwelling upon a terror-centric issue prevailing in Pakistan, a latest US Congressional Research Service (CRS) report offers a sharp reality check. It says Pakistan remains a haven for a wide array of terrorist groups. Despite the 2014 National Action Plan's aim to dismantle all armed militias, 15 major groups continue to operate across five broad categories—globally oriented, Afghanistan-oriented, India- and Kashmir-oriented, domestically oriented, and sectarian—as per the report, as quoted extensively in *The Times of India*. 12 of these 15 groups are designated as Foreign Terrorist Organisations (FTOs) under US law, with most driven by extremist ideology. The report underscores a fundamental failure in dismantling these networks, noting that both US- and UN-designated terrorist organisations continue to operate openly on Pakistani soil. Particular emphasis is placed on India-centric groups like Hizbul Mujahideen and Jaish-e-Muhammed (JeM), which maintain active cadres of 1,500 and 500 armed supporters, respectively. On the regional front, Pakistan remains a base for India-specific groups like Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT), Jaish, and Hizbul, which seek the annexation of Kashmir.

Further, US officials have also linked the Haqqani Network to Pakistan's own intelligence services. Despite being removed from the Financial Action Task Force (FATF)

"grey list" in 2022, Pakistan remains designated by the US as a "Country of Particular Concern" for religious freedom, as some madrassas continue teaching doctrines that could lead to greater acceptance of extremist ideology. From the dormant anti-Shia Sipah-e-Sahaba to the active Lashkar-e-Jhangvi, and Al Qaeda in the Indian Subcontinent, the sheer diversity of these outfits illustrates a multi-layered security challenge that neither airstrikes nor diplomatic manoeuvres have been able to resolve, the report revealed. The reality is further punctuated by a spike in terrorism-linked deaths that reached 4,001 in 2025—the highest in 11 years. Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP) remains the deadliest domestic threat, seeking Sharia law in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa (KP).

Coming back to the Defence Minister's unsavoury comments, the Pakistan establishment would do well to refrain from such irresponsible and provocative statements. They surely lack political or diplomatic maturity. Munir and other Pakistani ministers are perhaps under the wrong notion that the US, particularly President Trump, has its hand on them. Trump is known to be unpredictable, mercurial, and tentative. Drawing strength from the US and using a militarist tenor against India might prove counterproductive to Pakistan, as the world today is highly volatile, and igniting any fresh spark could lead to catastrophic consequences. India, too, is more vigilant than before and fully geared to foil any misadventure by Pakistan, be it covert or otherwise.

Views expressed are personal

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CRISIS FOR URBAN WORKERS

The violent turn of the Noida protests is unfortunate, but the workers' distress cannot be ignored. When wages fail to match rising living costs, frustration is inevitable. Authorities must address inflation, ensure fair pay, and restore order through dialogue. Ignoring such grievances risks deepening unrest among vulnerable labour communities across urban India today.

— AKSHARA NAUDIYAL Uttarakhand

Lessons from Ambedkar

Ambedkar's lessons in education, self-respect and resilience guide students to overcome barriers; write OP Singh & Chandan Kumar Jha

Dr Bhim Rao Ambedkar's life is one of the most powerful examples of resilience, intellectual excellence, and social transformation. His journey reflects great lessons for young students, especially those from underprivileged backgrounds. Ambedkar strongly believed that education is the most powerful tool to break the chains of inequality. His famous message, "Educate, Agitate, Organise," emphasises that education must come first. For school and college students, this means taking learning seriously, using education as a weapon against ignorance, and striving for excellence despite challenges. Ambedkar never compromised on his self-respect. Even when society treated him unfairly, he maintained dignity and confidence. He believed that self-respect is the foundation of progress. Many students from marginalised backgrounds struggle with self-doubt due to societal pressures.

Ambedkar's life reminds them that confidence in one's abilities can overcome even the toughest barriers. For students in school, college, and higher education, this highlights the importance of curiosity beyond textbooks. Education should not be limited to passing exams but should involve understanding, questioning, and applying knowledge. Developing a habit of reading, critical thinking, and continuous learning can transform a student's life. Ambedkar used his education to fight social injustice. He did not just gain knowledge for personal success but used it to uplift society. He advocated for the rights of the oppressed and worked tirelessly to ensure equality through legal and constitutional means. Ambedkar's success was not accidental; it was built on discipline and relentless hard work. He spent long hours studying and writing, often under difficult conditions. Students today, who may be distracted by digital media and other pressures, can learn the importance of focus and time management. Consistent effort, rather than short bursts of study, leads to long-term success. Students should learn to think critically and not accept everything blindly. Education should empower them to question, analyse, and contribute to positive change in society.

Ambedkar's vision was not limited to one community; he worked for the upliftment of all marginalised groups. His life teaches the importance of empathy and inclusivity. In educational institutions, students should practice respect for diversity across caste, class, gender, and culture. Creating inclusive environments in schools and colleges helps build a more equitable society. Let's express our gratitude and keep sourcing inspiration from the life experiences of Baba Saheb Ambedkar. In conclusion, the life of Dr BR Ambedkar stands as a continual source of inspiration for both students and society at large. His unwavering commitment to education, despite severe social and economic challenges, demonstrates that knowledge and determination can transform one's destiny. For students, his journey reinforces the importance of hard work, resilience, and a clear sense of purpose in achieving personal and academic excellence for the upliftment of society.

At a broader level, Ambedkar's life teaches invaluable lessons about justice, equality, and social responsibility. His efforts to create an inclusive society remind us that true progress lies in uplifting others and challenging injustice with courage and integrity. Ultimately, his legacy encourages individuals to not only strive for personal success but also contribute meaningfully toward building a fair and compassionate society. Let us all remember the struggles, sacrifices, and extraordinary contributions of B. R. Ambedkar, whose life continues to inspire generations. His vision of an equitable and empowered society calls upon each one of us to uphold the values of justice, equality, and education in our daily lives. By learning from his perseverance and dedication, we can strive to overcome our own challenges with determination and purpose.

As responsible citizens, it is our collective duty to work hard and contribute toward the realisation of a Viksit Bharat and to establish India as a Vishwaguru on the global stage. Let us commit ourselves to excellence, innovation, and social responsibility, ensuring that our efforts not only lead to personal success but also to the progress and prosperity of the nation as a whole.

Views expressed are personal

A Question of Control?

The CAPF Act 2026 raises constitutional concerns, reigniting tensions over cadre rights, autonomy and governance-judiciary balance



SANJIV KRISHAN SOOD

The new law raises deeper concerns about constitutional principles and the future of cadre autonomy

Hijacking of the debate around the necessity of the recently notified CAPF (Administrative Reforms) Act, 2026—from important constitutional issues arising out of the over-turning of a well-considered judicial pronouncement by the Supreme Court, and national security implications, to the presumed superiority of coordination abilities, training, and strategic vision of IPS officers—is unfortunate and needs to be put in proper perspective. This narrative has mainly come from retired and serving IPS officers, besides politicians belonging to the party in power. The contempt that these IPS officers display towards the CAPF cadres is reminiscent of what the then Prime Minister of Britain, Churchill, is said to have displayed towards Indian leaders at the time of independence.

The myth of IPS superiority gets busted by the fact that 119 out of 122 Indian Police Service (IPS) probationers of the 2016 batch failed one or more academic or physical tests at the Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel National Police Academy (SVPNPA). While they graduated, they were required to retake exams, with three attempts allowed before potential discharge. There may be similar examples in other batches, too, that we do not know of.

While the IPS officers may be good insofar as their policing and investigative skills are



The debate is about justice, experience and the rule of law

concerned—even that is questionable, keeping in view the bad state of law and order, rampant corruption, and poor standards of investigation in most states of the country—they certainly are out of depth in managing the operational, logistical, and personnel management issues of the specialised Central Armed Police Forces, commonly referred to as CAPFs.

The inability of the IPS leaders at the helm of affairs of the CAPFs to address the festering issues of these forces is apparent from the fact that the units and sub-units of these forces continue to face an acute deficiency of infrastructure at the unit and sub-unit levels, leading to a high workload on jawans, subordinates, and officers, and therefore work-life imbalance. This is manifest in the large number of voluntary retirements in these forces. The abysmal failure to identify and induct technology suitable for the specialised operational domain of these forces emanates from their not being

familiar with the ground-level operational environment. The failure of HR policies is manifest in acute stagnation not only amongst officers' cadres but also amongst subordinate officers and other ranks of the five forces. The inability to ensure proper work-life balance and adequate facilities at BOPs/COBs is a major cause of the large number of voluntary retirements.

The Supreme Court order of May 25 and the subsequent dismissal of the review petition by the Government aimed to "progressively reduce" IPS deputation in CAPFs up to the level of Joint Secretary, i.e., Inspector General, and allow the CAPF cadre officers to occupy all positions up to that level. This would have enhanced the promotional avenues for cadre officers to a limited extent. However, the major impact of the implementation of the Supreme Court order would have been to eliminate the financial deprivation that the cadre officers face by according them the benefits

of Non-Functional Upgradation and thereby removing the double jeopardy—of stagnation as well as financial loss to the cadre officers. The Supreme Court order would have gone a long way in utilising the wide experience of the cadre officers in their respective professional domains at higher supervisory and policymaking levels, thus enabling these forces to align their policies in conformity with their operational necessities.

The CAPF (General Administration) Act, 2026, overturns the Supreme Court order without specifying coherent grounds. The Bill is in contravention of the law settled by the Supreme Court in several of its judgments. As late as November 8, 2025, the Supreme Court has asserted that the Legislature cannot override court judgments, but can fix legal defects through amendments.

The Act is certain to be challenged on this constitutional ground because it does not cure any legal lacunae. The challenge also arises on the grounds of violation of the fundamental rights of the cadre officers available to them under Articles 14 and 16.

The cadre officers of CPMF had achieved a hard-fought legal victory and were hopeful of its implementation, which would have brought closure to their struggles. However, that was not to be. They will now have to wait a few more years to finally get justice.

Views expressed are personal

LEBANON, ISRAEL TO START DIRECT TALKS TODAY

Israel and Hezbollah clash in strategic Lebanese village

BEIRUT: Fierce fighting rocked the strategic southern Lebanese town of Bint Jbeil on Monday, as Israeli troops appeared to encircle the area while Hezbollah militants launched rockets and artillery in an effort to push them back.

The clashes in the hilly town that overlooks the UN-mandated Blue Line dividing the two countries just over 2 miles (3.2 kilometers) away have intensified over the past week, after Iran and the United States agreed to a temporary truce. On Tuesday, Lebanon and Israel's ambassadors to the U.S. are set to meet in Washington for an in-person meeting in a bid to kick off a landmark series of direct negotiations.

Israel has scaled back its attacks in Lebanon, especially in Beirut, after a series of deadly strikes without warning hit the heart of the capital in some of its busiest residential and commercial areas, killing over 350 people.

At the same time, Israel appears to have stepped up strikes and ground invasion in southern Lebanon, where it intends to create a security zone along the Litani River, almost 20 miles (32 kilometers) from the border.

Bint Jbeil is among dozens of towns and villages south of the river that Israel called to evacuate early on in the war. The latest round of fighting was sparked by Hezbollah firing rockets into northern Israel on March 2, in solidarity with Iran.

At least 2,055 people have been killed in Israeli strikes in Lebanon, the Health Ministry said, among them 252 women,



Workers remove the rubble as rescuers keep searching for a missing person at a destroyed building that was hit on April 8, in an Israeli airstrike in Beirut on Monday

Highlights

- » Israel has scaled back its attacks in Lebanon
- » At least 2,055 people have been killed in Israeli strikes in Lebanon so far

HEZBOLLAH ON SUNDAY CLAIMED AT LEAST FIVE ATTACKS ON ISRAELI TROOPS

165 children, and 87 medical workers, while 6,588 were wounded.

Lebanon's state-run National News Agency has reported Israeli ground forces making their way into the town

with most of the exit roads cut off. Local media reported dozens of Hezbollah gunmen were largely encircled.

Bint Jbeil sits in a strategic position

The Israeli military said its troops surrounded Hezbollah infrastructure and started ground operations in Bint Jbeil and surrounding areas, killing over 100 Hezbollah fighters. Hezbollah did not immediately announce any fatalities among its ranks, and Israel did not comment on its military casualties.

Hezbollah on Sunday claimed at least five attacks on Israeli troops in the town and outskirts with rockets, artillery and drones.

According to the

group's statements, Israeli troops were positioned near a school, a hospital and juncture that surrounds the heart of Bint Jbeil.

That day, Israel said its troops attacked Hezbollah forces surveilling from the Bint Jbeil Government Hospital and found a cache of machine guns and rockets.

When Israel occupied southern Lebanon until its withdrawal in 2000, it had relied on Bint Jbeil and other elevated locations for strategic vantage points.

A major turning point was Hezbollah retaking the hilly town, and the victory speech by then-Secretary General Hassan Nasrallah in a stadium there.

UK lauds Pakistan's peace diplomacy

ISLAMABAD: The UK Foreign Secretary on Monday lauded Pakistan's role in promoting peace in West Asia after it hosted talks between the US and Iran.

Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper stated during a telephone conversation with Deputy Prime Minister/Foreign Minister (DPM/FM) Ishaq Dar. According to a statement by the Foreign Office, they exchanged views on the recently held direct US-Iran negotiations at the Islamabad talks, as well as broader regional developments.

The UK Foreign Secretary "appreciated Pakistan's constructive role in promoting peace and stability in the region," it added.

Dar underscored the need for all parties to respect and implement the ceasefire fully.

He also reaffirmed Pakistan's continued commitment to advancing dialogue and diplomacy.

Vance-led talks helped build goodwill with Iran: Report

WASHINGTON: US Vice President JD Vance-led talks for peace with Iran may have been unsuccessful, but the 21-hour-long discussions helped build goodwill with the new leadership in Tehran, according to a media report.

The Washington Post, quoting unnamed US officials, reported that the measure of goodwill established during the talks in Islamabad has made Washington believe that Iran may accept their terms to end the deadly and costly war.

It said that President Donald Trump's announcement of a US blockade of the Strait of Hormuz could force Iran to agree to a deal.

"A US official with knowledge of the negotiations, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss the closed-door talks, said Vance was keenly aware going into the negotiations of the mistrust and risk of misunderstanding between the United States and Iran," the report said.

The official said Vance and the Iran negotiators had developed rapport and became



Vice President JD Vance (right), speaks during a news conference

'Vance was keenly aware going into the negotiations of the mistrust and risk of misunderstanding between the United States and Iran'

warmer with each other.

Trump appeared to share the assessment. "We had a very intensive negotiation,

and toward the end, it got very friendly," he told Fox News' "Sunday Morning Futures". "And we got just about every point we needed except for the fact that they refuse to give up their nuclear ambition," he said. The Post report said it became clear to the US team once talks began that the Iranians did not fully appreciate the far-reaching nature of the Trump administration's insistence that any deal must centre on prohibiting Iran from ever obtaining a nuclear weapon.

Starmer rules out support for US blockade of Hormuz

LONDON: UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer on Monday ruled out British support for US President Donald Trump's planned blockade of Iranian ports and coastal areas, including the crucial shipping route of the Strait of Hormuz.

During a weekend phone call with French President Emmanuel Macron, Starmer reiterated the UK stance of the need to "work with a wide coalition of partners to protect freedom of navigation" given the strategic importance



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

of the Strait for global trade and energy supplies.

He confirmed the presence of mine-sweepers and anti-drone defensive presence in the region as he stressed that British military capability will

continue to focus on getting the Strait "fully open".

"What we've been doing over the last few weeks – and this was part of what I was discussing with the Gulf states last week – is bringing countries together to keep the Strait open, not shut," Starmer told BBC Radio.

"We're not supporting the blockade and all of the marshallingly diplomatically, politically and capability – we do have mine-sweeping capability, I won't go into operational

matters, but we do have that capability – that's all focused, from our point of view, on getting the Strait fully open," he said.

Starmer also reiterated the UK's position against being drawn into the US-Iran conflict.

"My decision has been very clearly that whatever the pressure – and there's been some considerable pressure – we're not getting dragged into the war. The UK is not getting dragged in."

UN concerned as Oppn retakes a strategic town in South Sudan

JUBA: The UN has expressed concern over violence in the strategic town of Akobo in South Sudan's Jonglei State, which was retaken by opposition forces after they ousted government troops.

Fighting started over the weekend and the Sudan People's Liberation Army-in-Opposition spokesman Lam Paul Gabriel said on Monday that opposition fighters captured the town and took military vehicles and weapons. Government troops,

which seized the town in March, withdrew. The public service minister, Ezekiel Lol Gatkuoth, called the attacks "senseless and unjustified," saying the opposition forces had put civilians in harm's way. He said the army would provide more details on what transpired, but the army spokesperson refused to comment. The South Sudanese government has been fighting opposition forces since a 2018 peace deal broke down about a year ago.

Pak FM Dar dials Wang

ISLAMABAD: Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi on Monday told his Pakistani counterpart Ishaq Dar that the top priority is to make every effort to prevent the US-Iran conflict from reigniting in West Asia and maintain the hard-won momentum of the ceasefire.

Dar held a telephone conversation with Wang and exchanged views on the recently concluded Islamabad Talks.

Trump lambasts Pope, extending feud over Iran war with 1st American pontiff

Pope Leo XIV says he does not fear President Trump

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump delivered an extraordinary broadcast against Pope Leo XIV on Sunday night, saying he didn't think the US-born global leader of the Catholic Church is "doing a very good job" and that "he's a very liberal person," while also suggesting the pontiff should "stop catering to the Radical Left".

Flying back to Washington from Florida, Trump used a lengthy social media post to sharply criticise Leo, then kept it up after deplaning, in comments on the tarmac to reporters. "I'm not a fan of Pope Leo," he said. Trump's comments came after Leo suggested over the weekend that a "delusion of omnipotence" is fuelling the US-Israel war in Iran.

Responding to the President, US-born Pope told reporters that the Vatican's appeals for peace and reconciliation are rooted in the Gospel, and that he doesn't fear the Trump administration.

"To put my message on the same plane as what the President has attempted to do here, I think is not under-



Pope Leo XIV arrives at the El Mouradia Presidential Palace in Algiers, on Monday, at the start of an 11-day apostolic journey to Africa

standing what the message of the Gospel is," Leo told AP aboard the papal plane en route to Algeria. "And I'm sorry to hear that but I will continue on what I believe is the mission of the church in the world today."

History's first US-born pope stressed that he was not making a direct attack against Trump or anyone else with his general appeal for peace and criticisms of the "delusion of omnipotence" that is fuelling the Iran wars and other conflicts around

the world.

"I will not enter into debate. The things that I say are certainly not meant as attacks on anyone. The message of the Gospel is very clear: Blessed are the peacemakers," Leo said.

"I will not shy away from announcing the message of the Gospel and inviting all people to look for ways of building bridges of peace and reconciliation, and looking for ways to avoid war any time that's possible."

Nepal PM, members of Cabinet discloses assets, draws criticism

The assets were made public as per their commitment to maintain transparency after assuming power

KATHMANDU: Prime Minister Balen Shah and members of the Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP)-led Cabinet have made their property details public, in line with their broader commitment to transparency after coming to power.

The Office of the Prime Minister and Council of Ministers released the disclosures on Sunday, in line with Section 50 of the Corruption Prevention Act, which requires public officials to submit their asset details within 60 days of assuming office.

The assets were made public as per their commitment to maintain transparency after assuming power.

The members have revealed significant holdings in bank deposits, land, shares and other assets.

However, the huge cash and non-cash property made public by the Balen Cabinet has invited criticism from different quarters.

As per the disclosures, Prime Minister Shah has Rs 14.6 million deposited in his bank account, with income sources mentioned as earnings from digital platforms, including Facebook and YouTube.

He owns houses and land in Kathmandu, Dhannusha and Mahottari districts. Besides, he has also declared 190 tola of ancestral gold among other valuables. (One tola is equivalent to 11.664 grams).



Nepal's Prime Minister Balen Shah

Key Points

- » The members have revealed significant holdings in bank deposits, land, shares and other

assets

- » The huge cash and non-cash property made public by Cabinet has invited criticism from different quarters

Similarly, Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle has disclosed share investments worth Rs 19 million and bank deposits of around Rs 9 million.

He also owns a residential house in Lalitpur worth Rs 20 million and land in multiple locations valued at Rs 107.5 million.

Sources of his assets are professional income and ancestral property.

Likewise, Home Minister Sudan Gurung has mentioned Rs 43.1 million in share investments, land in three districts and 89 tolas of gold.

The declaration of asset details is a mandatory provision under the

Corruption Prevention Act, which requires the prime minister and ministers to submit their property details within 60 days after assuming office.

Property details disclosed by Prime Minister Balen and his Cabinet members on Sunday have drawn some public concern and criticism too.

On Monday, a group of leftist students staged a protest in Kathmandu demanding that the sources of the publicly declared assets be disclosed and that an impartial investigation be conducted to ascertain how the ministers gathered their wealth.

Senegal has first conviction under law toughening punishment for homosexual acts

DAKAR: A court in Senegal has issued the first conviction under new law increasing the punishment for homosexuality.

A court in Dakar suburb Pikine-Guédiawaye sentenced a 24-year-old labourer on Friday to six years in prison and fined him 2 million CFA (\$3,300) for "acts against nature and public indecency." He was arrested earlier this month.

Senegal is the latest African country to impose harsher penalties against the LGBTQ+ community.

The law also punishes what it calls the "promotion" or "financing" of homosexuality, seen as an attempt to crack down on groups that support sexual and gender minorities.

IN UK, THERE WERE 3,700 ANTISEMITIC INCIDENTS IN 2025

Antisemitic attacks in 2025 led to highest number of fatalities in 30 years: Study

TEL AVIV: Last year saw the highest level of deadly violence against Jews in over three decades, with 20 people killed in antisemitic attacks, according to an annual study released by Tel Aviv University on Monday.

The violence, including a deadly attack at a Hanukkah celebration in Australia, continued a spike that began following Hamas Oct 7, 2023, attacks and Israel's subsequent war in Gaza, the report's authors said.

"The data raise concern that a high level of antisemitic incidents is becoming a normalised reality," said Uriya Shavit, the chief editor of the widely cited annual report.

Deadly antisemitic attacks were recorded on three continents, according to the report. Fifteen people were killed at



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

the holiday event at Sydney's Bondi Beach in December. There were additional fatalities in two antisemitic attacks in the US in Washington, DC, Colorado; and in Britain, where two people were killed at a Manchester synagogue on Yom Kippur, the holiest day of

the Jewish calendar.

The study found that 2025 was the deadliest year for antisemitic attacks since 1994, when the bombing of a Jewish community center in Argentina killed 85 people and wounded more than 300. An Argentine court has blamed

Iran and its Hezbollah proxy for the attack.

According to the report, there was a moderate increase in the overall number antisemitic incidents last year compared with 2024, but that total represents a huge jump from 2022, before the war in Gaza. The report tracks incidents that range from physical attacks and vandalism to verbal threats and harassment on social media.

"The peak in the number of incidents was recorded in the immediate aftermath of the Oct 7 attack, after which we began to see a downward trend – but unfortunately, that trend did not continue in 2025," Shavit said. In the United Kingdom, there were 3,700 antisemitic incidents in 2025, a small increase from 3,556 in 2024.

Format C-7
(for political parties to publish in
the Newspapers, social media platforms
& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been
selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why
other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates
(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020
of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No.
536 of 2011)

Name of the Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS
*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY
OF WEST BENGAL 2026
Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 112 - Kamarhati (General)Assembly
Constituency
Name of the Candidate - Madan Mitra

Sl. No.			
1.	Criminal Antecedents		
	a.	Nature of the offences	1. Offences Alleged Under: Sections 3 and 4 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act 2002. 2. Section 120(B) of the Indian Penal Code 1860, Sections 7, 13(2) R/W 13(1)(a), and 13(1)(d) of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988. 3. Sections 120(B), 420 and 409 of the Indian Penal Code 1860 and Sections 4 & 6 of the Prize chits and Money Circulation Scheme (Banning) Act 1978. 4. Section 283 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 5. Sections 353 and 506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 6. Sections 147,148,149,448 and 427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860 and Section 3 of the Prevention of Damage to Public Property Act, 1984.
	b.	Case no.	1. M.L Case No. 7 of 2021. 2. C B I / A C B / K O L K A T A - RC0102017A0010. 3. CBI SPE SCB SIT KOLKATA CASE NO. RC- 04/S/2014 4. G.R. CASE NO. 2562 OF 2002, arising out of FIR No. 259 OF 2002 5. GR. Case No. 3900 of 1999, arising out of FIR 526 OF 1999 6. G.R. Case No.1543 of 1998, arising out of FIR 258 OF 1998.
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned Judge Special Court (under PMLA), Bichar Bhawan Calcutta. 2. Learned Special Judge, (CBI), Bichar Bhawan, Kolkata. 3. Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate at Alipore. 4. Learned 9 th Judicial Magistrate Alipore. 5. Learned 7 th Metropolitan Magistrate Kolkata. 6. Learned 9 th Judicial Magistrate Alipore.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No 4. No 5. No 6. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(2) Name of the Constituency - 112- Kamarhati (General) Assembly Constituency
Name of the Candidate - Madan Mitra

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7
(for political parties to publish in
the Newspapers, social media platforms
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Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been
selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why
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of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No.
536 of 2011)

Name of the Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS
*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY
OF WEST BENGAL 2026
Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 103-Bijpur Assembly Constituency
Name of the Candidate - Subodh Adhikary

Sl. No.			
1.	Criminal Antecedents		
	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 341/323/325/427/506/34 of Indian Penal Code 1860, Sections 25/27 of Arms Act 1959. Vide C.S. No. 48/ 2021, U/S. 341/427/120B. 2. Sections 25/27 of Arms Act 1959. Vide C.S. No.386/18, dated 27/07/2018 sections 25(1-B) (a) of Arms Act 1959, 3. Section 286 of Indian Penal Code 1860, Section 4/5 E.S Act 1908. Vide C.S. no. 639/18, dated 30.11.2018, U/S. 286 IPC & 4/5 E.S. Act. 4. Sections 147/148/149/447/354/323/34 of Indian Penal Code 1860. Vide C.S. No. 280/10, dated 31.10.2010, U/S 147/341/323/506 IPC.
	b.	Case No.	1. P.S Case No. 261/ 2020, dated 10.07.2020, Bizpore Police Station) 2. P.S. Case No. 271/2018, dated 14.05.2018, Bizpore Police Station) 3. P.S. Case No. 260/2018, dated 04.05.2018, Bizpore Police Station) 4. P.S. Case No. 156/2010, dated 17.05.2010, Bizpore Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned ACJM BKP. 2. Learned 5 th Judicial Magistrate, BKP. 3. Learned 1 st Judicial Magistrate, BKP. 4. Learned ACJM BKP.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No 4. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	Thereasonsfortheselection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots politicalworkerwithstrongpublicengagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(2) Name of the Constituency - 103- Bijpur Assembly Constituency
Name of the Candidate - Subodh Adhikary

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

RIYADH AND ISLAMABAD SIGNED A MUTUAL DEFENCE PACT IN SEPT

Pak PM Shehbaz likely to visit Saudi Arabia within next 48 hours: Report

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif is likely to visit Saudi Arabia within the next 48 hours following an invitation from Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, a media report said on Monday.

During the visit, Shehbaz is expected to hold consultations on key regional and international developments, signalling continued diplomatic engagement between the two countries, Geo News reported.

The visit follows much-anticipated talks in Islamabad, which ran from Saturday into early Sunday and were the highest-level discussions between the two sides since Iran's 1979 Islamic Revolution.

The negotiations came days after a ceasefire between the US and Iran began last week, aimed at ending six weeks of



Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif

AP/PTI

fighting that has killed thousands of people across the Gulf, throttled vital supplies of energy and sparked fears of a wider regional conflict.

Discussions on financial cooperation are expected to feature prominently, particularly after

Saudi and Qatar promised to provide USD 5 billion in assistance for Pakistan.

The prime minister would be accompanied by Chief of Defence Forces Asim Munir, Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar, and Special Assistant Syed

Highlights

- » During the visit, Shehbaz is expected to hold consultations on key regional and international developments
- » The visit follows much-anticipated talks in Islamabad
- » Discussions on financial cooperation are expected to feature prominently

Tariq Fatemi.

Finance Minister Muhammad Aurangzeb is expected to join the delegation in Riyadh, subject to the completion of his ongoing visit to the US.

Riyadh and Islamabad signed a mutual defence pact in September 2025, com-

mitting both sides to treat any aggression against either country as an attack on both.

That significantly deepened a decades-old security partnership.

Recently, a Pakistani military contingent comprising around 13,000 soldiers and 10 to 18 jets has reached Saudi Arabia as part of the joint defence agreement.

The military contingent's deployment to King Abdulaziz Air Base in the Eastern Sector includes fighter jets and support aircraft from the Pakistan Air Force, the Saudi Ministry of Defence said last week.

The deployment aimed to enhance joint military coordination, improve operational readiness between the armed forces of the two countries, and support security and stability at regional and international levels, it added.

AGENCIES

Canadian PM Carney on verge of a majority govt in special election

TORONTO: Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney is on the verge of securing a majority government as special elections are held in three districts on Monday.

Votes are being cast in the Toronto-area districts of Scarborough Southwest and University-Rosedale, which are considered safe seats for Carney's Liberals, and in the Montreal-area district of Terrebonne, which is considered a toss-up.

Winning just one of them would give Carney a majority. The Liberals now have 171 members of Parliament in the House of Commons. They need 172 to secure a majority government, which would allow them to unilaterally pass any bill.

Once the Liberals get that, they could stay in power until 2029 without the need for a new general election.

The results are expected Monday night. Five defections from opposition parties to Carney, including four from the main opposition Conservative party, have put Carney's Liber-



Canadian PM Mark Carney

“THE LIBERALS NOW HAVE 171 MEMBERS OF PARLIAMENT IN THE HOUSE OF COMMONS”

als on the cusp of the majority.

One of those defectors referenced Carney's speech at the World Economic Forum in Davos, Switzerland, as helping his decision. In the speech, Carney condemned economic coercion by great powers against smaller countries and received widespread praise for his remarks.

Carney won Canada's election last year fuelled by public anger over US President Don-

ald Trump's annexation threats.

Carney, former head of the Bank of England as well as Canada's central bank, has moved the Liberals to the centre-right since replacing Justin Trudeau as prime minister in 2025.

Daniel Béland, a political science professor at McGill University in Montreal, said the Liberals are almost certain to win the two Toronto seats and have a shot at winning in Terrebonne.

Béland said the deterioration of Canada-US relations under the second Trump presidency has convinced many Canadians, including people who do not identify as Liberal, to rally behind the prime minister.

“Carney has thus far proved that he is an astute politician, despite the fact that he only formally entered the political arena in January of last year,” Béland said. “The Davos speech has certainly helped boost Carney's support at home, and he is now significantly more popular than when he became prime minister nearly 13 months ago.”

AGENCIES

Judge dismisses Trump's \$10bn lawsuit against WSJ, Murdoch

WASHINGTON: A federal judge dismissed President Donald Trump's \$10 billion defamation lawsuit against the Wall Street Journal and Rupert Murdoch on Monday over a story on his ties to Jeffrey Epstein.

US District Judge Darrin P. Gayles in Florida wrote in the order that Trump had failed to make the argument that the article was published with the intent to be malicious, but gave the president a chance to file an amended complaint.

Trump filed the lawsuit in July, following up on a promise to sue the paper almost immediately after it put a new spotlight on his well-documented relationship with Epstein by publishing an article that described a sexually suggestive letter that the newspaper

The letter was subsequently released publicly by Congress, which subpoenaed the records from Epstein's estate

said bore Trump's signature and was included in a 2003 album compiled for Epstein's 50th birthday. The letter was subsequently released publicly by Congress, which subpoenaed the records from Epstein's estate.

The ruling marks yet another blow in the Trump administration's efforts to manage fallout over its release of the Epstein files.

AGENCIES



A humanoid robot squares off against a visitor during a demonstration at an exhibition in Hong Kong on Monday

AP/PTI

Humanoid robots show off their language, boxing skills in Hong Kong

HONG KONG: A humanoid robot about the size of a primary school student had something to share in Hong Kong — it sang songs and spoke to people in Mandarin and English, answering whatever questions they posed and delighting the audience around it.

More than 100 robots were showcased at two exhibitions starting Monday at the Hong Kong Convention and Exhibition Center.

The X2 Ultra robot from China's prominent humanoid robot manufacturer AGIBOT Innovation (Shanghai) Technology Co. was among them.

When asked about its hobbies, the robot's list went from doing sports and dancing to studying technology and listening to music.

Describing the people in front of it is no challenge either: “a woman holding a

phone, a woman holding a bag and a phone, a man holding a camera,” it said at one point.

Calvin Chiu, the chief operating officer of Novautek Autonomous Driving, AGIBOT's agent in Hong Kong, said that the robot can provide emo-

tional satisfaction to humans through conversations and serve as a teacher to older adults and children. Different robots can be programmed with different personalities, too.

“It would be like a friend,” Chiu said.

AGENCIES

PEMRA issues notice to channel for running ‘Indian content’ while reporting news of Asha Bhosle’s death

LAHORE: Pakistan's media watchdog on Monday issued a show-cause notice to a leading news channel for running “Indian content” while broadcasting the news about the death of legendary singer Asha Bhosle.

A ban on Indian content in Pakistan has been in place since 2018.

The Pakistan Electronic Media Regulatory Authority (PEMRA) issued the show-cause notice to GeoNews seeking an explanation as to why it

aired Indian content along with the news of Bhosle's death.

The leading news channel is considered close to the Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz government and the military establishment.

Bhosle passed away on Sunday due to multi-organ failure. She was 92.

“It has always been customary to revisit and celebrate the work of iconic artists when reporting on them. In fact, for an artist of Asha Bhosle's stature, we should have shared

The leading news channel is considered close to the Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz government and the military establishment

even more of her timeless and memorable songs than we did. Yet, Pakistan's electronic media

regulator, PEMRA, has chosen to restrict this,” Azhar Abbas, the Managing Director of GeoNews, said in a post on X.

Abbas said that art, like knowledge, is a shared heritage of humanity, and it should not be confined by borders.

“Asha Bhosle herself admired Pakistan's legendary singer Noor Jahan, whom she fondly called her ‘elder sister.’ She collaborated with Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan and brought to life the poetry of great Urdu poets like Nasir Kazmi.

“In times of war and conflict, art and artists should not become casualties. Intellectuals, musicians, and creators are often the very voices that stand against hatred and division, and the ones who bring people closer together,” he added.

The PEMRA said GeoNews broadcast of Indian songs and visuals from Indian films while airing news of Bhosle's death is a wilful defiance of the judgment of the Supreme Court of Pakistan that banned the airing of Indian content.

AGENCIES

Office of the Collector, District South Bastar Dantewada (C.G.)
(Sports and Youth Welfare Department)

SI.No./ 33. /RFP/Sports/2025-26/ Dantewada, Dated 13/04/2026

Second Revised Call

Subject: Second Revised Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Execution Partner for Establishment, Operation, and Management of Football Residential & Training Academy, Dantewada

Issue Date: 13-04-2026

The District Sports Office, Dantewada, Government of Chhattisgarh, hereby issues the **Second Revised Call for Proposals** for selection of an Execution Partner for the establishment, operation, and management of a structured Football Residential & Training Academy in Dantewada District. All prospective bidders are hereby informed that **certain revisions have been made in the RFP document**. This document shall be treated as the **complete and final RFP**.

Accordingly, all eligible and interested football training organizations, academies, foundations, and sports management companies are advised to **carefully review the revised RFP document** before submission.

The objective of this initiative is to create a district-level football excellence center and a long-term talent pipeline, with special focus on tribal and remote-area youth.

Tender Submission Deadline:
Last Date: **25-04-2026** till 4:00 PM | Opening Date: **26-04-2026** during office hours

The detailed revised RFP document can be downloaded from the official website: <https://dantewada.nic.in/>
(Bidders are advised to regularly visit the website for updates, if any.)

Eligible applicants must submit their physical proposals (in two envelopes – Technical and Financial) in accordance with the **revised RFP document** to:

District Sports Officer,
Office of District Sports Office,
Collectorate Campus, Dantewada,
District Dantewada, Chhattisgarh – 494441

Important Notes:

- Late submissions will not be considered.
- Proposals will be opened in the presence of the evaluation committee at the District Administration Office, Dantewada.
- The Authority reserves the right to accept or reject any proposal without assigning any reason.

Assistant District Sports Officer (ADSO)
Nadal Officer – Football Academy Project
District Sports Office
District Dantewada, Chhattisgarh
Pin Code – 494441

G 262700173/8

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No. 1, Teliwadia, Raipur (C.G.) – 492006
CIN : U45200CG1981S0601853, PAN : AABCM6283N, GST Reg No: U45200CG1981S0601853
Phone : 0771-6621000 Fax : 0771-2583794
Website : www.csidc.in, Email: address.csidc.cg@nic.in, raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (1st call)
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

No.: 02&03/CSIDC/E.E. Division-4/2026-27/ Raipur, dated 10 /04/2026

Online tenders are invited in **Form-B (Item rate basis)** for S. N. 01 & **Form A (Percentage Basis)** for S. N. 02, from “A” class Electrical license contractors Registered in Appropriate class in new registration system “Unified Registration System- (e-Registration)” with Chhattisgarh P.W.D website <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> at appropriate class, for the following works:-

S.No.	Name of Work	Class of Contractor Eligible to Tender	Time allowed including rainy season	Estimated Cost (INR Lacs)	EMD (INR Rs.)	Cost of Tender Doc. (INR) including GST 18%
01	“Supply , Installation testing & Commissioning of 02 Nos 11 KV / 0.433 KV Sub-Station (2 x 500 KVA) Including Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) for 3 Years for Electricity Connections at Working Women Hostel Koni & Uslapur , Bilaspur (C.G.)”.	Registered in C class in new registration system “Unified Registration System- (e-Registration)”	04 Months	111.99 Lacs	84,000/-	3540/-
02	“Supply, Installation & Testing of Octagonal poles and LED light fitting 120 watt & High Mast Lighting (Height-20 M) & Dismantling of existing Pole/Lights for Street Lighting at Sirgitti Overbridge & Near Railway Line Sector-B, Industrial Area , Sirgitti, Bilaspur (C.G.)”	Registered in D class in new registration system “Unified Registration System- (e-Registration)”	02 Months	27.18 Lacs	20,500/-	885/-

The tender document and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 10/04/2026 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE:

- 1) The interested tenders for online submission of tender may contact CG eProc Helpdesk. Operated by **Mjunction Services Limited**, they may reach Helpdesk using 18002582502 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in.
- 2) Tenderer may contact to E.E., Div-I, CSIDC, Udyog Bhawan in working hours to clear their doubt if any before online submission of the tender.

samvaid 47500/3 **Executive Engineer, Division-I**

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr.No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Dinesh Kumar Yadav/ Mumtaz/ LBFDB00002185815	House No 407, Sector 55 of The Urban Estate, Faridabad, Haryana- 121001, April 09, 2026	August 29, 2025 Rs. 48,81,710/-	Firozabad (Uttar Pradesh), Faridabad (Haryana)
2.	Sunil Kumar Bhardwaj/ Bimal Sharma/ LBFDB00006400566/ LBFDB00006372789	Unit No T9-407, Floor No-4, Type-C, Aditya Homes, Situated At Village Sikri, Main Mathura Road, Sector-143 District, Anoj, Mandi, Faridabad, Haryana- 121002/ April 09, 2026	December 30, 2025 Rs. 22,58,695.76/-	Delhi, Faridabad (Haryana)
3.	Karan Duggal/ Shashi Duggal/ Sunrise Allied Services/ LBFDB00005634764	Plot No- Gh-17, Flat No- 02 First Floor Sector-46, Citizen Welfare Organization, Faridabad, Haryana- 121001/ April 09, 2026	December 30, 2025 Rs. 39,97,845.77/-	Faridabad (Haryana)

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: April 14, 2026 Place: Delhi/ NCR & Faridabad (Haryana)

Sincerely Authorised Officer For ICICI Bank Ltd.

THE HOME LIVING CO-OPERATIVE GROUP HOUSING SOCIETY LTD.
(Regn No. 1225-GH)
Plot no. 14, Sector-9, Dwarka, New Delhi-110077

PUBLIC NOTICE

In terms of the provisions of Schedule-VII of DCS Rules, 2007, the general public is hereby informed that the following members namely- (1) Sh. Bilal Ahmed S/o Sh.Naim Ahmed (Membership No.07) (2) Smt. Preeti Singh W/o Sh. Dalbir Singh (Membership No. 09) (3) Smt. ManjulMadhu W/o Sh. M.L. Madhu (Membership No. 10) (4) Smt. Shehna W/o Sh. Naseem Ahmed (Membership No. 11) (5) Sh. Syed Mohammed Adil S/o Sh. S.M. Arif (Membership No. 12) (6) Sh. Azad Singh S/o Sh. KanwarLal (Membership No. 17) (7) Sh. Anil Kumar S/o Sh. VaidParkash (Membership No. 22) (8) Smt. Kamla Singh W/o Sh. Gulab Singh (Membership No. 24) (9) Sh. Prof. B.S. Dahiya S/o Sh. B.R. Dahiya (Membership No. 38) (10) Sh. ShailandraKohli S/o Sh. S.R. Kohli (Membership No. 43) (11) Smt. Anjula Berry D/W/o Sh. Sukhdev (Membership No. 47) (12) Smt. Indu W/o Sh. PramodChandra (Membership No. 48) (13) Smt. ManjulaTrehon D/o Sh. S. Lota (Membership No. 50) (14) Sh. Sahail Ahmed S/o Sh. Rahim Baksh (Membership No. 53) (15) Sh. SurajBhan S/o Sh. KanwarLal (Membership No. 61) (16) Sh. VipinMalhotra S/o Smt. SurinderMalhotra (Membership No. 71) (17) Sh. Mohan LalAhuja S/o Sh. KanwarBhan (Membership No. 73) (18) Sh. Karandeep S/o Smt. ShavinderKaur (Membership No. 75) (19) Sh. Dinesh Yadav S/o Sh.Hari Singh (Membership No. 76) (20) Smt. Sucheta D/W/o Sh. S. Raj (Membership No. 138) (21) Sh. Nirmal Chandra Mathur S/o Sh. Harish Chandra Mathur (Membership No. 79) (22) Sh. Abdul Simaap S/o Smt. Anisa Khan (Membership No. 85) (23) Smt. ChahanaBindrani D/o Sh. Sunil Madnani (Membership No. 94) (24) Smt. AnishaMadnani W/o Sh. Sunil Madnani (Membership No. 107) (25) Sh. Raju K Khetwani S/o Kaniyalal (Membership No. 108) (26) Smt. Geeta K Aggarwal W/o K.L. Aggarwal (Membership No. 110) (27) Sh. ShailobhAggarwal S/o Sh. G.C. Aggarwal (Membership No. 112) (28) Sh. Col. S.P. Ramon S/o Lata Sh. P.K. Ramon (Membership No. 113) (29) Sh. Guljeet Singh Minhas S/o Sh. Jaswant Singh Minhas (Membership No. 114) (30) Sh. Rohit Pal S/o Sh. L.S. Paul (Membership No. 115) (31) Sh. Kapil Kumar S/o Sh. N.K. Aggarwal (Membership No. 116) (32) Sh. Ashok Kumar S/o Sh. Amolak Chandra (Membership No. 117) (33) Sh. Sh. Mahesh Yadav S/o Sh. H.S. Yadav (Membership No. 118) (34) Sh. Dinesh Kumar Kaushik S/o Sh. O.P. Sharma (Membership No. 135) (35) Sh. AnujBhargava S/o Shri A C Bhargava (Membership No. 137) (36) Sh. Harpreet Singh Malhotra S/o Sh. GurbirMalhotra (Membership No. 138) (37) Sh. AnandLakhota S/o D.P. Lakhota (Membership No. 139) (38) Sh. Harsh Mohanta S/o Smt. ShantaMohanta (Membership No. 141) (39) Sh. UzairNafis S/o Smt. Shaheena Begum (Membership No. 143) (40) Sh. Shahadil S/o Smt. KherulNisa (Membership No. 144) (41) Sh. Harish Hans & Smt. Pinyhy Hans S/o Mr. Hans (Membership No. 145) (42) Sh. R Pradeep Kumar S/o Sh. R.C. Pillai (Membership No. 147) (43) Sh. Harsh Vahra S/o Sh. R.L. Vahra (Membership No. 148) (44) Sh. Tarun Kaput S/o Sh. T.K. Kapur (Membership No. 149) (45) Sh. Shahroz S/o Mrs. SabihaRafiq (Membership No. 153) (46) Sh. Sanjeev Kumar Sehraawat S/o Sh. Azad Singh (Membership No. 154) (47) Sh. Hossar Singh Father of Sh. Gulab Singh (Membership No. 155) (48) Sh. K.S. Rawat S/o Sh. Rawat (Membership No. 158) (49) Sh. SudeshYadav S/o Sh. Hari Singh Yadav (Membership No. 160) (50) Sh. Suhailmroz S/o Smt. ChandrakalaShafiq (Membership No. 161) (51) Sh. Mohd. Shamsin S/o Smt. M.D. Nasim (Membership No. 163) (52) Sh. Lalit Kumar Lakhani S/o Sh. S.K. Lakhani (Membership No. 164) (53) Sh. Kulbhushan Seth S/o Sh. K.K. Seth (Membership No. 165) (54) Sh. Vikram Sharma & Poonam Sharma S/o Sh. Kulbhushan Sharma (Membership No. 166) (55) Smt. RashmiDawra W/o Sh. SandeepDawra (Membership No. 167) (56) Smt. Anurita Seth D/o Smt. Sukernak Kapoor (Membership No. 169) (57) Sh. B.K. De S/o Sh. A.K. De (Membership No. 170) (58) Smt. Parvinitala Jain & Gaurav Jain W/o Sh. Sushil Jain (Membership No. 171) (59) Sh. Krishan K Bhargava S/o Sh. O.P. Bhargav (Membership No. 172) (60) Sh. Raj Kumar Jain S/o Sh. Naresh Jain (Membership No. 173) (61) Sh. A.K. Suri S/o Sh. K.L. Suri (Membership No. 174) (62) Smt. MeenaKumari W/o Sh. Harendra Singh Yadav (Membership No. 177) (63) Sh. B.S. Dahiya S/o Sh. Shiv LalDahiya (Membership No. 178) (64) Smt. Bhagirathi Paul W/o Sh. D.S. Paul (Membership No. 183) (65) Sh. JagdishSachdeva S/o Sh. GurbachanLalSachdeva (Membership No. 184) (66) Sh. BenuMalhotra W/o Sh. H. Malhotra (Membership No. 185) (67) Sh. VirenderKhaneja S/o Sh. SubhashKhaneja (Membership No. 187) (68) Sh. A.G. Thamizharasan S/o Sh. I.A. Gambaenabadnan (Membership No. 188) (69) Smt. MadhuDua W/o PrakashLalDua (Membership No. 189) (70) Smt. Sharda Krishnan S/o Sh. J. Krishnan (Membership No. 190) (71) Smt. ParmeshwarJagoriaRaj R.K. Jagoria S/o Sh. N.R. Jagoria (Membership No. 191) (72) Sh. Harbansl S/o Sh. GurbachanRai (Membership No. 192) (73) Sh. SubashBhat S/o Dr. R.N. Bhat (Membership No. 193) (74) Sh. Vijay Gupta S/o Sh. Tej Ram Gupta (Membership No. 194) (75) Smt. Saroj Mehta W/o Sh. Deepak Mehta (Membership No. 195) (76) Smt. Shabnam&JameelChaudhary S/o Sh. S.A. Chaudhary (Membership No. 196) (77) Sh. Hunaid Ahmed Dar S/o Smt. Anessa Dar (Membership No. 197) (78) Sh. Mayank Sharma S/o Sh. J.C. Sharma (Membership No. 199) (79) Smt. ChitraChutnani & Sh. Pramod Kumar Chutnani W/o Sh. Pramod Kumar Chutnani (Membership No. 200) (80) Sh. Mohammad Nadin S/o Sh. M.D. Naseem (Membership No. 201) (81) Sh. RohitSoni S/o Sh. H.B. Soni (Membership No. 202) (82) Smt. UshaKaul W/o Sh. Anil Sarraf (Membership No. 203) (83) Sh. RohitRaina S/o Sh. Mokhanlal (Membership No. 204) (84) Smt. Anita Mathur W/o Dr. Ashok Kaul (Membership No. 205) (85) Sh. Manish Vashist S/o Sh. B.P. Vashist (Membership No. 206) (86) Sh. Suresh Arora S/o Sh. Mohi Ram (Membership No. 207) (87) Sh. Arvind Sharma S/o Sh. J.P. Sharma (Membership No. 208) (88) Sh. RavinderGirdhar S/o Sh. ManoharLalGirdhar (Membership No. 209) (89) Sh. NavinFonia S/o Sh. Surender Singh Fonia (Membership No. 210) (90) Sh. AkhileshArora S/o Sh. Suresh Arora (Membership No. 212) (91) Smt. Narendrakaur W/o Dr. Nand Kishore (Membership No. 213) (92) Smt. Kela Devi W/o Sh. Jay Kishor Singh (Membership No. 214) (93) Smt. Manju Mishra W/o Sh. Abhishek Kumar Mishra (Membership No. 215) (94) Sh. Arun Kumar Yadav S/o Sh. Satbir Singh Yadav (Membership No. 216) (95) Sh. Somvir Singh S/o Sh. Rajbir Singh (Membership No. 217) (96) Sh. MaulikDagar S/o Sh. Manjeet Kumar (Membership No. 218) (97) Sh. Ravi Solanki S/o Sh. Pawan Kumar Solanki (Membership No. 219) (98) Sh. Naveen Kumar S/o Sh. Mahipal Singh (Membership No. 220) (99) Smt. Parveen Devi W/o Sh. RajveerChauhan (Membership No. 221) (100) Sh. Sachin Kumar S/o Sh. Brij Kishore (Membership No. 222) (101) Smt. Kamlesh Rani W/o Sh. Rajender Prasad (Membership No. 223) (102) Sh. Rajesh Yadav S/o Sh. Sushil Prasad Yadav (Membership No. 224) (103) Sh. Arun Kumar S/o Sh. Ashok Kumar (Membership No. 225) (104) Sh. Jitender S/o Sh. Joginder (Membership No. 226) (105) Smt. Savtri W/o Sh. Ram Avtar (Membership No. 227) & (106) Sh. KusumJidani W/o Sh. Karam Chand (Membership No. 228) in respect of The Home Living Co-operative Group Housing Society Limited is being forwarded by the Managing Committee of the said society for allotment of flats in their names through RCS/DDA as per the provisions of DCS Act & Rules framed thereunder & guidelines thereof. Any person, member(s) having any objection may file before the President/ Secretary of The Home Living CGHS Ltd (Regn. No. 1225/GH) at Plot No. 14, Sector-09, Dwarka, New Delhi- 110077 or before the office of the Registrar, Co-operative Societies, Govt. of NCT of Delhi, Old Court's Building, Parliament Street, New Delhi-110001 within five days of publication of this notice and no objections shall be entertained thereafter in any manner whatsoever and the society will proceed further accordingly.

For & on behalf of
The Home Living CGHS Ltd.
-sd-
President / Secretary

Dated 14.04.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE
My client Sh. Jagdish Bhadana s/o Sh. Mehar Chand Bhadana R/o H.No. 3E/17A, BP, Faridabad and his wife Kamla Devi has disowned /debarred his son Shiv/ Nikhil Bhadana and his wife Geeta and sons Gaurav and Rajat from all his moveable and immovable properties and severed all his relationship from him, from all intend and purposes, as he roams in bad society. Any body deals with him in any manner he/she shall be doing so at his/her own risk, cost, and responsibility and my client his close relative, properties shall not be answerable for any acts, deeds and things done by Shiv/Nikhil Bhadana and his wife Geeta and sons Gaurav and Rajat

Public Notice
My Client namely Dolly wife of Shri Suraj Prakash, resident of D-2*-185, Madangir, Dr. Ambedkar Nagar, Sector-4, New Delhi-110062 and D-2*-26, Madangir, Dr. Ambedkar Nagar, Sector-4, New Delhi-110062, do hereby disown and debar her son Punit and daughter-in-law Tannu from all her movable and immovable properties with immediate effect due to their inappropriate behavior. Henceforth, they shall have no right, title, interest or claim whatsoever in any of her properties. If any person deals with them regarding her properties, the same shall be at their own risk and responsibility. **Hitesh Lodwal, Advocate, Ch. No. 412, Saket Court, New Delhi-110017.**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ranjan, S/o Ram Dayal R/o H.No.C-102, Vandana Vihar, Nihal Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.1110/2023 u/s 379/356/411/34 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ranjan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ranjan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ranjan of FIR No.1110/2023 u/s 379/356/411/34 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.05.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Ankit Karan Singh
Metropolitan Magistrate-08
Room No.30, Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/4723/OD/2026

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, रौंटी

सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना



नाम—चम्पु उर्रव, उम्र—21 वर्ष, रैंक—5 फीट, रंग—सॉबला, पहनावा—टी शर्ट एवं पलाजो पहनी हुई है।

उपरोक्त लापता महिला चम्पु उर्रव, पेट—बहुधा उर्रव, सा—चलियो खस्की टोली, थाना—चान्हो, जिला—रौंटी जो दिनांक—28.03.2026 को अपने घर से बगैर बताए कहीं चली जो आजतक अपने घर वापस नहीं आई है। जिसके संबंध में चान्हो थाना समूह संख्या—13/2026, दिनांक—04.04.2026 दर्ज कर इनकी खोजबीन की जा रही है। उपरोक्त सूचना को सार्वजनिक किया जाना आवश्यक है।

अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि उपरोक्त लापता महिला कहीं मिलती / दिखती है तो इसके संबंध में वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय में या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।

Email ID (mc-dcb@jhpolicse.gov.in) —9431706188
पुलिस उपधीक्षक, खलारी, रौंटी। —9431706189
थाना प्रमारी, चान्हो, रौंटी। वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, रौंटी

PR 377445 Police(26-27).D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Javed Abbas S/o Fakra Alam R/o H. No. B-185, Shankar Niwas, 2nd Floor, Ganga Vihar, Gokulpuri, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 665/2022 U/s 380/411/IPC, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Javed Abbas** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Javed Abbas** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Javed Abbas** of case **FIR No. 665/2022 U/s 380/411/IPC, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Pankaj Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01
North East District, Room No. 73, 5th Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
DP/4769/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE No. CSP-KSF_01_2026-27

On behalf of the President of India, Chief Engineer/TSP, Northern Railway, Headquarters office, Baroda House, New Delhi-110001 invites the following tender through E-Procurement system:

S. N	Tender No.	Brief Description	Cost of tender document	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Estimated Tender value (in Rs.)	Date & Time of opening of tender	Period of Completion
1	CSP-KSF_01_2026-27	Supplying, fixing and commissioning of various STR-2025 equipment, machines, control panels etc. with warranty for 02 years at Concrete Sleeper Plant /N.Rly./ Khalispur-Varanasi	NIL	77700/-	3887000/-	08.05.2026 at 15.00	03 months
2	CSP-KSF_02_2026-27	Supply of Stone chips (20 mm & 10 mm Size) and Coarse sand as per IS-383- 1970 from the given sources/quarries for a period of Two years to Concrete Sleeper Plant, Khalispur, Varanasi by road transport including loading, leading, unloading and stacking within premises, of Concrete Sleeper Plant, N.Rly./Khalispur Varanasi.	NIL	620100/-	31003882/-	12.05.2026 at 15.00	24 months

Note: The complete information of above E-Procurement tender is available on website "www.ireps.gov.in." No. CSP-KSF_01_2026-27 Dated 13.04.2026 1243/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

ADITYA BIRLA CAPITAL LIMITED

Registered Office: Indian Rayon Compound, Vervaval, Gujarat - 362266.
Corporate Office : 12th Floor, R Teck Park, Nirilon Complex, Near Hub Mall, Goregaon (East), Mumbai-400 063, MH.

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE

15 days Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with provision to Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

On account of the amalgamation between Aditya Birla Finance Ltd and Aditya Birla Capital Ltd. vide the Scheme of Amalgamation dated 11.03.2024 duly recorded in the Order passed by the National Company Law Tribunal - Ahmedabad on 24.03.2025, all SARFAESI actions initiated by Aditya Birla Finance Ltd. in relation to the mortgaged property mentioned, stands transferred to Aditya Birla Capital Ltd., the amalgamated company. Accordingly, the Authorized Officer of Aditya Birla Capital Limited / Secured Creditor had TAKEN POSSESSION of the following secured assets pursuant to notice issued under Sec. 13(2) of Securitisation & Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (SARFAESI) for recovery of the secured debts of the secured creditor, for the dues as mentioned herein below with further charges and cost thereon from the following Borrowers and Co-Borrowers. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrowers and Co-Borrowers that e-auction of the following property for realization of the debts due to the Aditya Birla Capital Limited will be held on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" basis.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrowers & Co-Borrowers	Description of Properties / Secured Assets	Reserve Price (in Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (in Rs.) / Incremental Value (in Rs.)	Demand Notice Date & Total Amt. (in Rs.)
1.	1. M/s. Jai Krishna Enterprises, Through its Proprietor 2. Mr. Atul Jain, S/o. Mr. Rajendra Kumar Jain 3. Mrs. Alka Jain, S/o. Mr. Atul Jain 4. Mrs. Shalini Jain, W/o. Mr. Vikash Jain 5. Mrs. Neelam Jain, W/o. Mr. Sandeep Jain Lan: ABNMST500000825974 AND ABNMST500000825953	"All that piece and parcel of The Double Stored Residential House Bearing Municipal No. 703 to 707 Having An Area Measuring 251 Sq. Mtrs. Situated At Mohalla Kalyan Singh, Jabbar Mandi, Kasba Mawana Kalan, Tehsil - Mawana, District Meerut, Uttar Pradesh And Bounded As: East: Road; West: House of Smt. Narayani Devi, North: House of Smt. Sita Devi W/o. Ragubar Dayal And House of Deepak Kumar S/o. Jagdishpal Singh, South: House of Smt. Marto Devi W/o. Kishan Lal And House of Smt. Murtidevi W/o. Japirakshi	Rs. 64,39,500/- (Rupees Sixty Four Lacs Thirty Nine Thousand Five Hundred Only)	Rs. 6,43,950/- (Rupees Six Lacs Forty Three Thousand Nine Hundred And Fifty Only) Rs. 25,000/- (Rs. Twenty Five Thousand Only)	11.11.2024 & Rs. 59,03,289.70/- (Rupees Fifty Nine Lakhs Three Thousand Two Hundred Eighty Nine and Seventy Paise Only) As On 11.11.2024

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in Aditya Birla Capital Limited / Secured Creditor's website i.e. <https://abfi.adityabirlacapital.com/Pages/Individual/Properties-for-Auction-under-SARFAESI-Act.aspx> or <https://BidDeal.in> Contact Nos.: Aditya Birla Capital Limited, Authorized Officer Ashish Srivastava (9696515559), Parneet Singh (9720029337), Apoorva Danthi (9930909725), Ved Prakash Mishra(9004026790), Mohit Sharma(9873913955), Komal Patil(9867895795), Jahirul Laskari(9706003075)
Place : Meerut, Uttar Pradesh Date : 14.04.2026
Sd/- Authorised Officer, Aditya Birla Capital Limited

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Sharukh @Amir S/o Salim R/o E-14/G-376, New Seelampur, Welcome, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 31733/2021 U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Sharukh @Amir** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sharukh @ Amir** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Sharukh @Amir in FIR No. 31733/2021 U/s 379/411 IPC, PS Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.05.2026**.

By order
Ms Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Court No. 19
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/4108/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. Pc/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Surkhasha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Deepanshu S/o Ajit Paswan R/o Gali No.30-B, Swatantra Nagar, Narela, Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No 346/2022 Dt. 02.05.2022 U/s 33/38 Excise Act** has been registered at **PS. Narela industrial area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Deepanshu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Deepanshu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Deepanshu** of under **FIR No 346/2022 Dt. 02.05.2022 U/s 33/38 Excise Act** registered at **PS. Narela industrial area, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Jyoti Nain,
JMFC-07 (North), 1st floor,
Room No. 06,Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4805/ON/2026 (court matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Himanshu, S/o: Mukesh, R/o: H.No. 610, VPO- Ladpur Mohalla, Brihan Panna, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 162/2021, U/s: 33/58 Delhi Excise Act. P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Himanshu**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Himanshu**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Himanshu, of FIR No. 162/2021, U/s: 33/58 Delhi Excise Act. P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.05.2026**.

By Order
Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North West Court No. 109 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/4639/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (CIVIL), CSPGCL, Shed No. 11, Dangania, Raipur-492013 Phone No. 0771-2574562, website www.cspc.co.in E-mail:- civilprojectcmg@gmail.com

No.04-04/W/57 Raipur, date 09.04.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited through CSPCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from contractors registered in appropriate class in CSPGCL in three-part tendering system. The unregistered contractor having experience in Govt./PSU/local bodies/Power Generating Companies / Reputed private sector in India only may be considered on submission of experience certificate for following work as mentioned below:-

Tender Specifi. No.	Name of Work	NIT value
CEC/DSPM -KE/W/ 2026/04	Demolishing and disposal of Balance 324 units old F-type staff quarters at DSPM -TPS, CSPGCL, Korba East	56.30 Lacs

Note:- (i) The detailed NIT, Eligibility Criteria, Tender document & other details can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal <https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in> in:50724/irj/portal.(ii) NIT value is inclusive of GST @ 18%. Chief Engineer (Civil)
SAVE ELECTRICITY samvad 47483/1 CSPGCL, Raipur

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tenders through E-Tendering (E-Procurement System)

Principal Chief materials manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the president of India invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items.

S. No.	Tender No	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
1.	82263501A	Medium (17*15*3.2cm) Polyurethane Ester Foam Dressing Kit Which Has (Hydrophobic Foam For Fast Granulation) Polyurethane Ester Foam In Spiral Cut Sheet For Suction Unit With Pressure Of - 25mm Hg To <200 mm Hg For Installation (Not Irrigation), 2 Pieces Of Foam Along 6 Drape And Two Canister Of 500 ml. Each (Containing Sodium Polyacrylate To Covert Exudate In To Gel, So No Cross Contamination) With At Least 5 Or More Lumens Tube To Prevent Leakage And Blockage, One Cassette For Solutio Distribution And Two Alcohol-Free Liquid Barrier Film That Protects Peri Wound Skin And At Least 5 Or More Lumens In Trac Pad Which Will Be Used For Instillation Therapy Unit. Dgci & BIS /US FDA Approved/ European CE Approved By An Agency With 4 Digit Notification Approved Quality. Measurements +/-10% (Asper attached specification)	240 Set	05.05.26

Note:- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No manual offer will be entertained. Tender Notice No. TabInj. Medicines Date: 11.04.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1223/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Sh. Raman Kumar S/o Sh. Shankar Prasad R/o 33A/9 Kishangarh, Vasant Kunj, South West Delhi 110070** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg. 5998/2016 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Shalimar Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Sh. Raman Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sh. Raman Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Sh. Raman Kumar in Case Reg. 5998/2016 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Shalimar Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.05.2026**.

By order
Shri Apoorv Bhardwaj
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No.113, 1st Floor, North West District
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4813/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC/84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pawandeep Singh Virdi S/o Gurdeep Singh Virdi R/o M-5, 2nd Floor, Greater Kailash, Part-1, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 345/2024 U/S 420/468/471 IPC, PS Vijay Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Pawandeep Singh Virdi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Pawandeep Singh Virdi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pawandeep Singh Virdi of FIR No. 345/2024 U/S 420/468/471 IPC, PS Vijay Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **26.05.2026 at 10:00 am**.

By Order,
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
North-West 1st Floor, Room No. 109
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/4664/RD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Vijay @ Machhar S/o Ambika Rai R/o: Plot No.-22, Gali No.-08, Block-B, Shahbad Daiy, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 690/22, U/S 25/54/59 A. Act, PS Shahbad Daiy, Outer North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vijay @ Machhar** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vijay @ Machhar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Vijay @ Machhar** the said accused of **FIR No. 690/22, U/S 25/54/59 A. Act, PS Shahbad Daiy, Outer North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05,
North Distt., Room No.-114, 1st Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4820/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rahul @ Murga, S/o Sh. Harbans @ Pintu, R/o H.No. 261, Gali No. 5, Shiv Vihar, Vishal Garden, Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 20081/2022, U/s 411 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rahul @ Murga** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rahul @ Murga** has absconded (or are concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rahul @ Murga** accused of **FIR No. 20081/2022, U/s 411 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.05.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11, West
Room No. 31, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/4774/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Raju Yadav, S/o. Banarsi Yadav, R/o.: RZ-G 35, Nihal Vihar, Delhi Also at: 326, Madipur Village, Madipur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.03/2016 Dt.02.01.2016 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act AND 457/380/411/34 IPC** registered at **PS Mundka, Outer District, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Raju Yadav** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Raju Yadav** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Raju Yadav**, accused of **FIR No.03/2016 Dt.02.01.2016 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act AND 457/380/411/34 IPC, P.S Mundka, Outer District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.06.2026**.

By Order, Gaurav Singal,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06 (West),
Room No. 355, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

DP/4706/OD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Namely: **Mahender, S/o. Jetha Ram, R/o.: House of Kailash, Gali No.14, Vijay Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.56/2021 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act** registered at **PS Bawana, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Mahender** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Mahender** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mahender**, accused of **FIR No. 56/2021 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Bawana, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.05.2026**.

By Order, Ms. Bharti Beniwal,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North)
Court No.114, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4754/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Sheru S/o Riyazul R/o H.No. 293, Gali No. D-2, 25 Futa Road, Nehru Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 115/2019 U/s 12 G. Act, PS Bhajanpura, Distt. North-East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant

Retail inflation inches up to 3.4% in March: Govt data

The food inflation, based on consumer price index, was estimated at 3.87% in March as against 3.47% in February

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Retail inflation inched up marginally to 3.4 per cent in March compared to 3.21 per cent in the preceding month, mainly due to uptick in certain food items, amid the ongoing West Asia crisis, according to government data released on Monday.

The food inflation, based on the consumer price index (CPI), was estimated at 3.87 per cent in March as against 3.47 per cent in February.

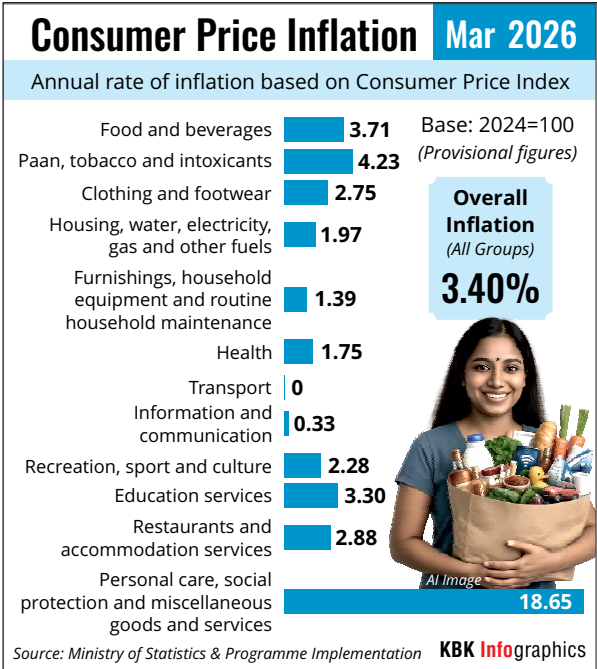
The retail inflation released by the National Statistics Office (NSO) is based on a new series with a base year 2024.

The March CPI remains below the Reserve Bank's median target of 4 per cent.

High inflation was noticed during March in gold and silver jewellery, coconut (copra), tomato, and cauliflower.

On the other hand, inflation was in negative in onion, potato, garlic, arhar dal, and chickpeas, according to the NSO data.

The CPI was at 1.65 per cent in 'electricity, gas and other fuels' segment during March as against 1.52 in the preceding month. Inflation rates for rural and urban segments are 3.63 per cent and 3.11 per cent, respectively.



Housing inflation rate for March 2026 was 2.11 per cent.

Highest inflation was in Telangana at 5.83 per cent and the lowest in Mizoram at 0.66 per cent.

Commenting on CPI data, ASSOCHAM President Nirmal K Minda said the government's approach to manage prices by keeping petrol and diesel rates unchanged, despite a sharp rise

in international crude oil prices, is highly commendable.

The RBI has also supported economic activity by maintaining a stable repo rate, he added.

ICRA Chief Economist Aditi Nayar said the CPI inflation rose slightly to 3.4 per cent in March over February, indicating a mild initial impact of the West Asian crisis on the headline number.

Highlights

» The retail inflation released by the National Statistics Office is based on a new series with a base year 2024

» The March CPI remains below the Reserve Bank's median target of 4 per cent

» High inflation was noticed during March in gold and silver jewellery, coconut (copra), tomato, and cauliflower

» Inflation rates for rural and urban segments are 3.63 per cent and 3.11 per cent, respectively

"The sequential uptick in year-on-year inflation was driven by food and electricity, gas and other fuels groups, with the latter reflecting the impact of the West Asia crisis across LPG and alternate fuels," she said. NSO collects real-time price data from selected 1,407 urban markets (including online markets) and 1,465 villages covering all states/UTs.

Bourses decline nearly 1% after failed US-Iran talks, Sensex tanks over 702 pts

ICICI Bank, NTPC and Axis Bank were the winners

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Benchmark stock indices Sensex and Nifty closed nearly 1 per cent lower on Monday as the failure of US-Iran negotiations heightened concerns of a prolonged conflict driving crude oil prices sharply higher.

The 30-share BSE Sensex tumbled 702.68 points or 0.91 per cent to settle at 76,847.57. During the day, it dived 1,681.93 points or 2.16 per cent to 75,868.32.

The 50-share NSE Nifty plunged 207.95 points or 0.86 per cent to end at 23,842.65.

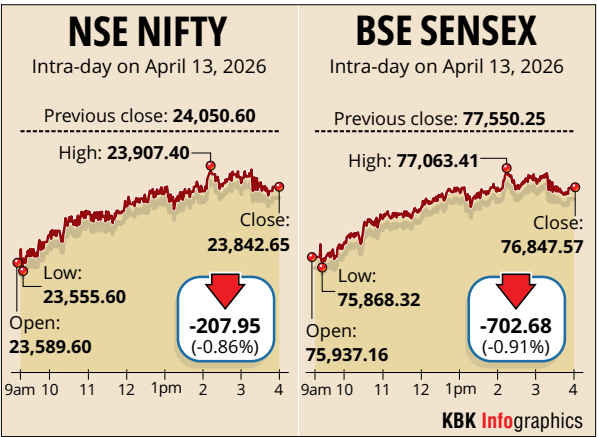
From the 30-Sensex firms, Maruti, InterGlobe Aviation, Bajaj Finance, Reliance Industries, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) and HDFC Bank were the biggest laggards.

ICICI Bank, NTPC and Axis Bank were the winners.

The US and Iran failed to reach a peace deal at their historic 21-hour talks in Pakistan, leaving the fate of a tenuous two-week ceasefire in doubt, with both sides attempting to hold each other responsible for the collapse of the negotiations.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 7.73 per cent to \$102.6 per barrel.

"Markets continue to derive limited support from last week's ceasefire framework, which remains intact for now and is encouraging selective buying interest along with a



From the 30-Sensex firms, Maruti, InterGlobe Aviation, Bajaj Finance, Reliance Industries, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) and HDFC Bank were the biggest laggards

buy-on-dips approach. This comes despite an initial negative reaction to the breakdown of US-Iran peace talks and the announcement of a US naval blockade in the Strait of Hormuz, which pushed crude prices above \$100/bbl," Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Limited, said.

Elevated oil prices are raising concerns around inflation, currency stability, and broader macro balances, thereby weighing on overall sentiment, Nair added.

US markets ended on a

mixed note on Friday.

"The weakness was primarily driven by escalating geopolitical tensions following the collapse of US-Iran talks, which triggered a sharp spike in crude oil prices and weighed on global sentiment," Ajit Mishra, SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.

The BSE MidCap Select index dropped 0.82 per cent and SmallCap Select index declined 0.33 per cent.

Auto edged lower by 2.10 per cent, followed by Energy (1.34 per cent), Services (1.31

Key Points

» The BSE MidCap Select index dropped 0.82 per cent and SmallCap Select index declined 0.33 per cent

» A total of 2,573 stocks declined, while 1,790 advanced and 201 remained unchanged on the BSE

» Auto edged lower by 2.10%, followed by Energy (1.34%), Services (1.31%), Oil & Gas (1.25%), Consumer Discretionary (1.21%), IT (1.17%) & BSE Focused IT (1.02%). Telecom, Utilities and Power were the winners

per cent), Oil & Gas (1.25 per cent), Consumer Discretionary (1.21 per cent), IT (1.17 per cent), and BSE Focused IT (1.02 per cent).

Telecommunication, Utilities and Power were the winners.

A total of 2,573 stocks declined, while 1,790 advanced and 201 remained unchanged on the BSE.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) turned buyers on Friday, buying stocks worth Rs 672.09 crore, according to exchange data.

PSX tanks over 5K pts as US-Iran talks end without breakthrough

KARACHI: Pakistan Stock Exchange (PSX) plunged over 5,000 points on Monday after the US-Iran peace talks in Islamabad ended without any breakthrough.

Trading started on a cautious note and by mid-day, the benchmark KSE-100 Index fell sharply by 5,353.67 points as heavy selling was witnessed by investors at the outset.

The KSE-100 Index dropped 4,567.31 points (-2.73%) to 162,624.06 within two hours of trading starting on the floor.

Later, despite the intraday volatility, the index showed signs of recovery as the bourse trimmed some losses to 4,450.97 points (-2.66%), with the index improving to 162,740.40 showing some stabilisation on the floor.

As the peace talks remaining inconclusive, a sharp surge was seen in global oil prices with crude benchmarks jumping over 7 per cent to exceed \$100/barrel.

US President Donald Trump's announcement of a blockade on maritime traffic to and from Iranian ports via the Strait of Hormuz also added to a panic selling mode by investors.

Kaukab Farshori of Capital Investments said the volatile environment was expected on the opening day of the week because of the uncertain global geopolitical situation.

AI without safeguards can amplify existing weaknesses in financial sector, says RBI DG

MUMBAI: Adoption of artificial intelligence (AI) without safeguards can amplify existing weaknesses and create new problems in the financial sector, Reserve Bank Deputy Governor Swaminathan J has said.

Delivering the CUB Shri V Narayanan Memorial Lecture at the SASTRA University, Thanjavur, he said artificial intelligence is beginning to reshape how financial institutions serve customers, process documents, assess credit, monitor risks, and strengthen oversight.

"The speed of that change is remarkable. The real question before us is not whether finance will become more intelligent but whether it will remain fair, accountable, inclusive, and humane," he said in the lecture delivered on Saturday.



AI-enabled systems can make customer interaction simpler, more intuitive, and responsive. It can also help improve credit delivery, he said.

"Used responsibly, AI can supplement traditional methods by drawing insights from a wider set of patterns in transaction behaviour, repayment flows and business activity.

"This can help identify viable borrowers who might otherwise remain excluded. For a country committed to

inclusive growth, this is a significant opportunity," Swaminathan said.

He further said AI can contribute meaningfully to fraud detection, risk management, besides in compliance and supervision.

"So, the promise is real. But, as history has proven, every powerful technology is a double-edged instrument," the Deputy Governor said.

If AI is adopted without adequate safeguards, it can amplify existing weaknesses and create entirely new forms of harm, he said.

"Therefore, the conversation about AI in finance must be balanced. We should neither be taken in by technological hype nor retreat into being defensive," he said.

The Deputy Governor high-

lighted five major concerns in this regard, including 'bias and unfair outcomes,' 'opacity,' 'data privacy and misuse,' 'model risk,' and 'cyber risk.'

"The enduring task, therefore, is to make finance more intelligent, without making it less human; to make it more digital, without making it less accountable; and to make it more inclusive, without making it less prudent. This, in a nutshell, is what can change and what must never change," Swaminathan said.

V Narayanan is remembered as a transformational leader of City Union Bank, founded in 1904 in Kumbakonam. Under his leadership, City Union Bank grew from a largely regional institution into one with a wider national presence.

HUDCO, NBCC MoU SIGNING



Two MoUs were signed on April 11, 2026 in the august presence of Sanjay Kulshrestha, Chairman & MD, HUDCO, and Dr. K P Mahadevaswamy, Chairman & MD, NBCC (India) Limited.. The MoUs were executed by Radha Roy, Executive Director, HUDCO; Bhushan Kumar, Executive Director (Business Development), HUDCO; and Pradeep Sharma, Executive Director (Business Development), NBCC. The MoUs was signed for Redevelopment of leasehold plot at Block No. 25, August Kranti Bhawan, Bhikaji Cama Place, New Delhi and providing funds by HUDCO for ongoing & upcoming projects of NBCC's self-sustainable model on mutually agreed terms.

NEW DELHI: India's edible oils imports rose 12 per cent annually to 11.73 lakh tonne in March on higher shipments of crude palm oil, and the imports may be subdued in coming months due to firm global prices and high freight cost amid the West Asia conflict, according to industry body SEA.

In a statement on Monday, the Solvent Extractors' Association of India (SEA) said imports of edible oils increased to 11,73,168 tonne in March from 10,45,281 tonne in the year-ago period.

As per the SEA data, imports of crude palm oil surged to 6,73,965 tonne last month from 3,43,949 tonne in March 2025.

Non-edible oil imports fell



to 13,401 tonne from 27,742 tonne.

Imports of vegetable oils (including both edible and non-edible) increased 11 per cent to 11,86,569 tonne last month from 10,73,023 tonne in March 2025.

India imports palm oil from Indonesia and Malaysia while soyabean oil is sourced from Argentina and Brazil. The country meets more than half of its domestic demand through imports.

During the first five months of 2025-26 marketing year, the total vegetable oil imports rose 8 per cent to 65,72,131 tonne from 60,96,923 tonne in the corresponding period of the preceding year.

Edible oil marketing year runs from November to October.

"Going forward, imports are likely to remain subdued in the short term unless global prices soften or currency conditions improve," SEA said.

In the longer term, the association said that India might continue balancing imports with increased focus on domestic oilseed production and diversification of sourcing to mitigate geopolitical risks.

SEA pointed out that the edible oil import in March 2026

declined 10 per cent to 11.73 lakh tonne from 12.92 lakh tonne in the previous month.

"The month-on-month decline in March suggests a clear demand correction driven by high international prices, rupee depreciation, and comfortable domestic availability, particularly from the mustard crop," the association said.

The sharp rise in imports during December 2025 to February 2026 points to front-loading by importers amid concerns over global supply disruptions, especially due to the ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict affecting sunflower oil, supply-side uncertainties in Southeast Asia for palm oil, and elevated freight costs linked to the West Asia tensions, the SEA said.

'R&D, investment push key for Indian drugmakers to lead globally'

'The govt continues to prioritise domestic manufacturing via PLI, bulk drugs scheme & bulk drug parks scheme'

NEW DELHI: India is well placed to take a leading role in the evolving global pharmaceutical landscape, which is increasingly focused on biologics, biosimilars and specialty medicines, Union Minister J P Nadda said on Monday, stressing the need for stronger R&D, higher investment and deeper industry participation.

In a video message at the India Pharma 2026 event, Nadda, who holds the Chemicals & Fertilisers and Health & Family Welfare portfolios, said India has long been recognised as the "pharmacy of the world" due to its dominance in afford-



Chemicals & Fertilisers & Health & Family Welfare, J P Nadda

able generic medicines.

However, the sector is undergoing rapid transformation globally.

"In this changing environment, India is best positioned not only to adapt but also to

CLOSER LOOK

» India has long been recognised as 'pharmacy of world' due to its dominance in affordable generic medicines

» Nadda highlighted that boosting research and development will be critical for the transition towards high-value innovation, backed by increased investments

» He also cited initiatives such as the Rs 10K cr Biopharma SHAKTI programme aimed at strengthening the sector

lead," he said, reaffirming the government's commitment to building a policy framework that supports innovation, strengthens research capabilities and promotes value-based growth.

Nadda highlighted that boosting research and development will be critical for the transition towards high-value innovation, backed by increased investments, stronger industry participa-

tion and effective public-private partnerships. He also cited initiatives such as the Rs 10,000-crore Biopharma SHAKTI programme aimed at strengthening the sector.

The government continues to prioritise domestic manufacturing through schemes like the production-linked incentive (PLI), bulk drugs scheme and the development of bulk drug parks to enhance self-reliance and resilient supply chains, he added.

Minister of State Anupriya Patel, also addressing the event, said the global generics model is under pressure and urged

Indian pharma companies to focus more on biosimilars, biologics and innovative drugs. She assured full government support to the industry.

Patel announced plans to restructure the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO), including hiring over 1,500 scientific experts. A network of 1,000 clinical trial sites will also be established, alongside greater use of artificial intelligence in drug discovery and development.

"These steps will help position India as a preferred destination for drug discovery and development," she said.

Silver declines ₹1,800, gold falls to ₹1.55 lakh/10 grams

NEW DELHI: Silver prices declined Rs 1,800 to Rs 2.45 lakh per kilogram in the national capital on Monday, while gold fell to Rs 1.55 lakh per 10 grams amid weak global cues.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the white metal decreased Rs 1,800, or nearly 1 per cent, to Rs 2,45,200 per kg (inclusive of all taxes) from Friday's closing level of Rs 2,47,000 per kg.

Gold of 99.9 per cent purity also edged lower by Rs 300 to Rs 1,55,000 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes). The yellow metal had finished at Rs 1,55,300 per 10 grams in the previous mar-

ket session.

"Precious metals opened lower on Monday after ceasefire talks between the US and Iran over the weekend failed to reach an agreement," Saumil Gandhi, Senior Analyst of Commodities at HDFC Securities, said.

He noted the setback in negotiations weighed on market sentiment and supported a rebound in the US dollar and Treasury yields, he added.

In the international markets, precious metal prices also moved lower. Spot silver slipped \$1.58, or 2.09 per cent, to \$74.31 per ounce, while gold fell \$25.92 to \$4,722.26 per ounce.

SHIPMENTS ARE 1ST IRANIAN CRUDE CARGOES TO REACH INDIA IN 7 YRS

Iranian crude returns to India as two tankers dock at key ports

The one-month exemption permitted the sale of Iranian oil already in transit, aimed at easing global supply disruptions & containing prices

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Two supertankers carrying Iranian crude have arrived at Indian ports on both the east and west coasts, marking the first such deliveries in nearly seven years, according to ship-tracking data.

Felicity, a very large crude carrier operated by the National Iranian Tanker Company, anchored off Sikka on Gujarat's coast late Sunday, carrying about 2 million barrels loaded at Kharg Island in mid-March.

A second tanker, Jaya, moored near Paradip on Odisha's coast around the same time. It is transporting a similar volume of crude, lifted from Kharg Island in late February, before the US and Israel launched military strikes against Iran, followed by Tehran's retaliation.

The shipments are the first Iranian crude cargoes to reach Indian shores in nearly seven years, following a sanctions waiver issued by the United States last month.

The one-month exemption permitted the sale of Iranian oil already in transit, aimed at eas-



Late last month, the tanker Ping Shun, carrying about 600,000 barrels of Iranian crude, was initially bound for Vadinar in Gujarat but diverted to China mid-voyage due to payment issues

ing global supply disruptions and containing prices.

However, after peace talks collapsed over the weekend, Washington announced a blockade of Iranian ports, seeking to curb Tehran's oil export revenues.

The buyers of the cargoes reaching Indian coasts have not been formally disclosed.

Paradip port is primarily

Highlights

» A very large crude carrier Felicity operated by National Iranian Tanker Co, anchored off Sikka on Gujarat's coast late Sunday

» It is carrying about two million barrels loaded at Kharg Island in mid-March

» A second tanker, Jaya, moored near Paradip, Odisha around same time. It is transporting a similar volume of crude, lifted from Kharg Island in late February

600,000 barrels of Iranian crude, was initially bound for Vadinar in Gujarat but diverted to China mid-voyage due to payment issues.

Had it reached Vadinar, oil on Ping Shun would have been the first Iranian barrels to reach Indian shores in seven years.

Historically, India was a major buyer of Iranian crude, importing significant volumes

of Iranian light and heavy grades due to strong refinery compatibility and favourable commercial terms.

Following sanctions tightening in 2018, imports ceased from May 2019, with volumes replaced by Middle Eastern, US and other grades. At peak, Iranian crude accounted for 11.5 per cent of India's total imports.

India used to buy 518,000 barrels per day of Iranian oil in 2018, which slowed to 268,000 bpd between January and May 2019 when the US granted waivers to a few buyers. There have been no imports since.

The key grades that Indian refiners used to purchase are Iran light and Iran heavy crudes.

The US last month waived sanctions on the purchase of Iranian oil at sea for 30 days in its latest attempt to ease oil prices that have been driven up by the US-Israeli war on Iran.

That window expires April 19. An estimated 95 million barrels of Iranian oil is on vessels on sea, of which around 51 million barrels could be sold to India, while the remaining are better suited for buyers in China and Southeast Asia.



The FoF 2.0 has been designed to continue the momentum of investments in startups, with an expanded scope over FFS 1.0

porting early growth stage startups, that is enterprises which are in the early phases of developing a technology, product or service.

On the other hand, the third segment will support tech-driven innovative manufacturing startups, while the fourth will cater to AIFs supporting sector/stage agnostic startups, it said.

It added that operational flexibilities will be incorporated in the guidelines to address the unique requirements of the segments.

This will include supporting AIFs with larger corporates to increase the availability of funds required for capital intensive segments such as deep tech and manufacturing; and supporting longer duration AIFs to cater to startups having longer R&D cycles and gestation periods.

The guidelines will be issued by the department. It will also include other aspects important to realise the expanded scope of the scheme.

The operational guidelines for FoF 2.0 will cover the detailed segment-wise provisions, eligibility criteria for AIFs and startups, selection and monitoring processes, reporting and assessment requirements, mechanism for disbursement of funds to implementation agencies and AIFs, and composition of investment committee.

Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI), which was the implementation agency of FFS 1.0, will also be the implementing agency for FoF 2.0.

In addition, another domestic agency shall be selected to implement the scheme.

Key Points

» The second tranche of Fund of Funds was approved by the Cabinet in February

» It is aimed at mobilising VC & support deep tech, tech-driven innovative mfg startups, and early-growth stage enterprises

» 'Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0 will have an expanded scope with segmented approach to target key segments for real innovation'

ICICI Prudential AMC profit up 10% to ₹763 cr in March qtr

NEW DELHI: ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company on Monday reported a 10.4 per cent rise in profit after tax (PAT) to Rs 763.4 crore during the March quarter, aided by higher income.

The company had posted a PAT of Rs 691.7 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous fiscal year.

Revenue from operations during the quarter rose 19.5 per cent to Rs 1,517.1 crore compared with Rs 1,269.1 crore in the year-ago period, the company said in a regulatory filing.

The board has recommended a final dividend of Rs 12.40 per equity share for FY26, subject to shareholders' approval at the ensuing annual general meeting.

For the full financial year ended March 2026, the asset manager reported a 24.4 per cent increase in PAT to Rs 3,298.6 crore from Rs 2,650.6 crore in FY25.

Revenue from operations for FY26 rose to Rs 5,764.6 crore compared with Rs 4,682.8 crore in the previous fiscal year.

This marks the company's second set of quarterly results since its stellar stock market debut in December 2025. Shares of ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company settled 1.14 per cent lower at Rs 3,351.6 apiece on the BSE. PFI

Net sales of non-financial pvt cos rise 11.4% in FY25

MUMBAI: Net sales of non-financial private companies increased at a slower pace of 11.4 per cent in FY25 as compared to 11.7 per cent in the previous year, according to RBI data released on Monday.

The RBI released data relating to financial performance of non-government non-financial (NGNF) private firms during FY25 based on audited annual accounts of select 15,919 companies reported in the Indian Accounting Standards format.

Services sector recorded 13.5 per cent growth in net sales during FY25, driven by 'Trade — wholesale & retail', 'Real Estate' and 'Transport and Storage services' sub-sectors. Sales growth in the manufacturing sector moderated marginally to 9.2 per cent in FY25 from 9.4 per cent in previous year. Total paid-up capital

(PUC) of these firms amounted to Rs 8,44,198 crore at end-March 2025, covering 40.3 per cent of total PUC of NGNF pvt ltd firms.

At the aggregate level, operating expenses increased relatively at higher rate in 2024-25 as compared to the previous year, driven by manufacturing expenses & remuneration to employees, the RBI said.

"Remuneration to employees increased for services sector while it moderated for the manufacturing sector," it said.

Further, operating profit & PAT continued to show double-digit growth in FY25 on top of high growth in FY24. Gross capital formation (which includes fixed assets & inventories) accounted for 48.2 per cent of total fund usage, up from 45.3 per cent in the previous year. PFI

Pvt cos' bond investments jump multi-fold in FY25: Reserve Bank

MUMBAI: Private sector companies' investments in bonds and debentures shot up multi-fold in FY25, the Reserve Bank said on Monday.

Analysis of 15,919 non-government, non-financial private companies by the central bank revealed that such entities invested Rs 35,981 crore in bonds or debentures in 2024-25, as against just Rs 224 crore in the year-ago period.

During this period, corporate bond issuances increased to Rs 9.87 lakh crore in FY25, compared to Rs 8.38 lakh crore in the previous fiscal year.

The yield on these instruments remained broadly in the range of 6.5-15 per cent across maturities and ratings on the BSE and NSE electronic bidding platform.

Indian bond market has

seen a sharp investment by the foreign investors, specifically in the government securities market after the JP Morgan announced the G-sec inclusion in to their index. The announcement came in the second half of FY24, and the actual inclusion happened in June 2024.

Further, another inclusion by Bloomberg Bond Index boosted the flows in the latter part of FY25.

Both these inclusion had lifted the prices of the bond making it a good investment avenue for the investors.

These price movements have followed in the corporate bond market too, leading to higher issuances and higher investment.

Further, RBI data showed that investment by these select

RBI rejects Ujjivan SFB's application for universal banking licence

NEW DELHI: Ujjivan Small Finance Bank on Monday said Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has rejected its application to transition to a universal bank and advised it to reapply after demonstrating a diversified loan portfolio.

In a regulatory filing, Ujjivan SFB said the Reserve Bank has taken note of the bank's recent efforts towards diversification of its loan portfolio.

"However, they were of the view that there is scope for progress in this area. Therefore, RBI has returned the above-mentioned application and advised the bank to consider applying again

after demonstrating a diversified loan portfolio," Ujjivan said.

In February 2025, Ujjivan SFB had announced submitting an application for universal banking licence to the Reserve Bank of India.

Shares of Ujjivan closed at Rs 60.34 apiece on the BSE. PFI

NCLAT adjourns hearing on Vedanta Ltd's plea against selection of Adani's bid for JAL

NEW DELHI: The National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) on Monday adjourned the hearing on petitions filed by the Vedanta Group challenging the selection of Adani Enterprises' bid for debt-laden Jaiprakash Associates Ltd (JAL) to April 16.

The matter was deferred due to a change in the bench composition following the unavailability of one member.

The tribunal was scheduled to hear concluding arguments from Vedanta before lenders and the resolution professional began their submissions. After discussions with parties, the case was listed for Thursday.



Vedanta has questioned the evaluation criteria used by JAL's lenders, arguing that the process undermined the "commercial wisdom" of the committee of creditors (CoC).

The group has filed two appeals against the March 17 order of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT), which

approved Adani Enterprises Ltd Rs 14,535 crore resolution plan.

Earlier, on March 24, NCLAT declined to stay the NCLT order but ruled that the resolution plan would remain subject to the outcome of Vedanta's appeals.

The interim order was later challenged in the Supreme Court of India, which also refused to grant a stay, while directing that any major policy decision by the monitoring committee must receive tribunal approval.

In the bidding process, Adani Enterprises secured 89 per cent of creditor votes, ahead of Vedanta and Dalmia

Bharat.

The committee of creditors has defended its decision, stating that bids were assessed on multiple parameters such as upfront cash, feasibility, and execution, not just overall value.

Jaiprakash Associates Ltd was admitted to insolvency proceedings in June 2024 after defaulting on loans worth Rs 57,185 crore.

The company has diversified assets across real estate, cement, hospitality, power, and infrastructure, including major projects in the Delhi-NCR region and cement plants in Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh. AGENCIES

India and Oman discuss ways to boost trade and investments

NEW DELHI: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Monday held talks with his Omani counterpart Anwar bin Hilal bin Hamdoun Al Jabri on ways to promote bilateral trade and investment.

In the last few days, Goyal has held discussions with the trade ministers of Saudi Arabia, UAE, Bahrain and Kuwait.

"Held a telecall with HE Anwar bin Hilal bin Hamdoun Al Jabri, Oman's Minister of Commerce, Industry and Investment Promotion. Discussed unlocking opportunities under the India-Oman CEPA to boost bilateral trade and investment ties for the mutual growth of both nations," Goyal said in

India-Oman bilateral trade was about \$10.5 billion (exports \$4 billion and imports \$6.54 billion) in 2024-25

a social media post.

The Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) was signed in Muscat in December 2025. It has not yet been implemented.

The pact will provide duty free access to 98 per cent of India's exports including textiles, agri and leather goods in

Oman. On the other hand, India will reduce tariffs on Omani products such as dates, marbles and petrochemical items.

India-Oman bilateral trade was about \$10.5 billion (exports \$4 billion and imports \$6.54 billion) in 2024-25.

The joint attack launched by the US and Israel on Iran had led to severe disruptions in the movement of ships in international waters, particularly to the West Asian nations.

The conflict has posed challenges for exporters to ship goods to the Gulf region, with which India had a bilateral trade of \$178 billion in 2024-25 (\$56.87 billion exports and \$121.67 billion imports). PFI

LIC board approves 1:1 bonus share issuance, 1st since its listing

NEW DELHI: Life Insurance Corporation (LIC) on Monday said its board has approved a bonus issuance of equity shares in 1:1 ratio, its first since listing.

In a regulatory filing, the bonus issue will be done by capitalising Rs 6,325 crore out of reserves and surplus available with LIC as of December 31, 2025.

"... it is to inform that the Board of Directors of the Life Insurance Corporation of India at its meeting held today, i.e., Monday, April 13, 2026... considered and approved the issuance of bonus equity shares in the proportion of 1:1, i.e., 1 (One) fully paid up equity



The bonus issue would pave way for further share sale or offer for sale (OFS) of LIC

share of Rs 10 each for every 1 (one) fully paid-up equity share

of Rs 10 each held by the Members of the Corporation as on the Record Date..." LIC said.

The government currently holds 96.5 per cent stake in LIC. It sold 3.5 per cent through an initial public offering (IPO) in May 2022 at a price band of Rs 902-949 a share. The share sale fetched the government around Rs 21,000 crore.

The bonus issue would pave way for further share sale or offer for sale (OFS) of LIC. The government, according to sources, is working on plans to come out with an OFS of LIC. Shares of LIC closed at Rs 804.25, up 0.71 per cent over previous close on BSE. AGENCIES

'No serious LPG shortage yet for auto component makers'

The ministry has advised industry to use cleaner fuels, such as electric furnaces & PNG

NEW DELHI: Auto component manufacturers have not reported any major LPG shortages so far, a senior government official said on Monday, noting that authorities are closely monitoring supplies amid evolving developments in West Asia.

Addressing an inter-ministerial briefing, Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Heavy Industries, Hanif Qureshi, said the government is in regular contact with the Auto Component Manufacturers Association (ACMA) and other industry groups to ensure adequate availability of

CLOSER LOOK

» 'The govt is in regular contact with the Auto Component Manufacturers Association and other industry groups'

» 'The government continues to promote electric mobility through schemes such as the PM E-DRIVE initiative and the production-linked incentive scheme for automobiles'

gas and avoid disruptions in production.

He added that the ministry is engaging with the automobile sector to address supply chain concerns and has advised companies to shift to cleaner alternatives such as electric furnaces and piped

production rose by 15-16 per cent in March.

On policy support, he said the government continues to promote electric mobility through schemes such as the PM E-DRIVE initiative and the production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme for automobiles, alongside efforts to boost domestic manufacturing under the AatmaNirbhar Bharat initiative.

The subsidy period for electric three-wheeler e-rickshaws has been extended to March 2028, while incentives for electric two-wheelers will now continue till July 31,

2026. The phased manufacturing programme timelines for trucks and buses have also been relaxed by six months to September 1, 2026.

Qureshi added that the government is pushing bio-fuels, with 20 per cent ethanol blending already achieved and increasing adoption of flex-fuel vehicles expected to reduce dependence on crude imports.

Efforts are also underway to strengthen supply chains, including a Rs 7,280-crore scheme to develop domestic rare earth magnet manufacturing capacity. AGENCIES

SARA THANKS FANS FOR 'DHURANDHAR' SUCCESS

The franchise has crossed Rs 3,000 crore at worldwide box office

Sara Arjun expressed heartfelt gratitude to audiences following the massive box office success of her films 'Dhurandhar' and 'Dhurandhar 2: The Revenge'. Sharing screenshots from the film with her leading man Ranveer Singh, the actress thanked fans for the overwhelming love the film has received over the past months.

Sara Arjun thanked fans for 'Dhurandhar' success. She captioned her post as, 'On behalf of Yalina, I thank you all for all the love'.

Sara's performance as Yalina has been widely appreciated, with audiences praising her emotional depth and screen presence in the action-packed narrative.

'Dhurandhar 2' crosses Rs 1,700 crore mark. The film, led by Ranveer Singh and directed by Aditya Dhar, has emerged as one of the biggest box office successes in recent times. In just 25 days, 'Dhurandhar 2' crossed the



Rs 1,700 crore mark worldwide, becoming the first Hindi film to achieve the milestone within such a short span.

With the sequel now crossing the Rs 1,700 crore mark, the two-part film has now officially surpassed the Rs 3,000 crore mark at the box office. The 'Dhurandhar' franchise has now become the first Indian film franchise to cross the Rs 3,000 crore mark with just two movies.

Domestically, the film has maintained a dominant run despite a gradual slowdown.



Amitabh Bachchan mourns Asha Bhosle's demise

He said her demise is a loss of an entire era

NEW DELHI: Bollywood megastar Amitabh Bachchan remembered legendary singer Asha Bhosle and said her demise is a loss of an entire era. Bhosle died on Sunday at the age of 92 due to multi-organ failure. She was admitted to Breach Candy Hospital in South Mumbai on Saturday evening following a chest infection and exhaustion.



Bachchan shared a note on his personal blog on Sunday as he paid tribute to the late singer and the voice behind several tracks such as 'Yeh Mera Dil', 'Tanha Tanha' and 'Dum Maro Dum'.

"Sorrow and grief... An entire era... An incredible... A phenomenal, astounding, prodigious and present... Lost yesterday... The iconic, legendary Asha Bhosle ji has left us... In immense grief," Bachchan wrote.

He added, "Her versatility in giving life to every song she gave voice to... Gone to the heavens and has left us an entire encyclopedia of eternal music... The body has left us, but her soul shall remain forever with us... Her voice - the soul, shall ever be immortalised."

He paid tribute to the the voice behind several tracks such as 'Yeh Mera Dil', 'Tanha Tanha' and 'Dum Maro Dum'

Bhosle recorded over 12,000 songs across 20 languages in her career spanning eight decades. She was honoured with the Dadasaheb Phalke Award in 2000 and Padma Vibhushan in 2008.

She has sung for several films featuring Bachchan, including tracks such as 'Yeh Mera Dil' in the 1978 film 'Don', 'Main Na Jhooth Boloon' in 'Indrajeet' and 'Do Lafzon Ki Hai Dil Ki Kahaani' in 'The Great Gambler'.

MUMBAI IS GETTING READY TO BE SPOOKED

JAI TALWAR

Aadyam, a theatre initiative by 'Aditya Birla Group', was conceptualised by Chairman Kumar Mangalam Birla in 2015 and has had a track record of presenting excellent theatre productions over the years. Presently in its 8th season, Aadyam is presenting 'Ankahi', the debut play, that forays into the supernatural thriller territory in its nationwide release, which began on March 17 in New Delhi.

This never-attempted genre is a Hindi adaptation of Susan Hill's celebrated horror story, 'The Woman in Black'. 'Ankahi' continues the previous season's tradition of transforming classical texts into immersive, theatrical experiences and is a Hindi adaptation of Susan Hill's celebrated horror story, 'The Woman in Black'. Its English adaptation for the stage by Stephen Mallatratt became one



Presently in its 8th season, Aadyam is presenting 'Ankahi', the debut play, that forays into the supernatural thriller territory

of the longest-running 'West End' productions.

It follows the story of a middle-aged lawyer, Sandeepan Chauhan, who is carrying the baggage of a haunted truth. In an attempt to free himself from it, he finds an unusual channel in a young, sceptical theatre actor who helps him

stage his horror - the account of how a simple legal matter of settling deceased Fatima Ilyas' estate unfolds a darker truth hidden in the marshes of West Bengal.

'Ankahi' has been directed by Vikranth Pawar, making this his first play for Aadyam Theatre. He has been instrumental in bringing

Broadway-style musicals to India for the first time with 'Beauty and the Beast'. The meticulously developed set and sound design create a world that the audience doesn't just experience; they immerse themselves in it.

Talking about his experience, Vikranth Pawar said, "Ankahi

marks my first play with Aadyam Theatre and the experience has been nothing short of exciting. My decision to adapt this classic horror story for the Indian stage was purely based on my conviction that the Indian audience has been waiting for a supernatural thriller to unfold on a live stage. The play packs some real scares and pulls you into pure drama and thrill for 90 minutes. It is a story that stays with you even when the lights turn back on."

The play's cast includes two powerhouse performers: Gopal Datt ('Tere Naam', 'Delhi Crime' and 'Bunty Aur Babli 2') as Sandeepan Chauhan and Rohit Chaudhary ('Bareilly ki Barfi', 'Jabariya Jodi' and 'The Forgotten Army') as the young actor.

The Mumbai shows will take place on April 18 and 19 at Jamshed Bhabha Theatre, NCPA and on May 2 and May 3, 2026, at Bal Gandharva Rang Mandir.

#ViralFeed

Kareena Kapoor Khan

gives a glamorous vibe in her red ensemble

I LOVE WOMEN WITH SPINE, SAYS SAI TAMHANKAR

The actress will be seen in Prime Video's 'Matka King'

OUR CORRESPONDENT



Sai Tamhankar is drawn to women characters with fire, voice and the ability to own their space. Barkha, from Prime Video's 'Matka King', is exactly that. Fiercely independent, deeply self-aware and unapologetically her own person, Barkha captured Tamhankar's admiration from the very first read. For an actor who gravitates toward roles with real depth, this one hit differently. Here, she opens up about the woman who won her over.

Reflecting on what makes her character Barkha special, Sai Tamhankar shared, "She's a fiery woman. Generally, when you play someone's wife, the impression is, 'Oh, it's just the wife's character'. But this woman has her own world and her own voice, and she exercises that voice, which really impressed me. She's not burdened by her husband's popularity, glamour or money. She has her own thought process and her own world and she keeps her individuality intact, which is such an amazing thing. I love women with spine and my character Barkha is someone with a spine."

Sai also revealed what drew her to become a fan of her own character, "Initially, she's really attracted to the glam, the popularity he's (Brij Bhatti) gaining and the money that's coming in. But then slowly, after seeing all this noise, she somehow ends up finding her own path. And that's what Barkha's journey is, it starts outwards and ends up inwards. It's very interesting to watch that. The most important thing for me was how she develops as a person through this journey and her development is quite interesting. I'm a fan of Barkha."

Created and written by Abhay Koranne and created, written and directed by Nagraj Popatrao Manjule, the series features Vijay Varma, Kritika Kamra, Sai Tamhankar, Siddharth Jadhav, Bhupendra Jadawat and Gulshan Grover in lead roles. The cast also boasts Bharat Jadhav, Girish Kulkarni, Jamie Lever, Kishor Kadam, Cyrus Sahukar, Arpita Sethia, Sambhaji Tangade, Ishtiyak Khan, Sanjiv Jotangia and Simran Ashwini in key roles.

'Matka King' is set to premiere exclusively on 'Prime Video' on April 17.

Neha Dhupia calls Aditya Dhar a 'pure genius'

The actress added her voice to the growing appreciation for 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge'



'Dhurandhar 2' continues its strong run at the box office even in its fourth week. According to 'Sacnilk', the film collected Rs 13.50 crore on Saturday, taking its India gross to Rs 1,279.80 crore and India net to Rs 1,068.92 crore. The actress added her voice to the growing appreciation for Ranveer Singh's 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge'. She watched the film recently and described the entire experience as 'phenomenal'.

She praised every aspect of the spy thriller, from performances to technical execution and especially commended director Aditya Dhar's vision.

Taking to her 'Instagram' stories, Neha Dhupia shared a photo with Ranveer Singh and wrote, "A bit late to join the mammoth #dhurandhar party... Honestly, I don't even know where to start. Every performance, every shot, every twist 'n' turn, every time they had dust in their eyes, we felt the wind in our faces @adityadharfilms, you are pure genius. What we witnessed yesterday was a performance that screams and looks perfection @ranveersingh what you can do no one else can... To each member of the cast and crew, mighty congratulations and what a time it is for us because sitting on the edge of that seat in the cinemas and experiencing what we did is just bloody phenomenal. NA @rampal72 @castingchhabra @therakeshbedi @saraarjun and the entire team... I tip my hat off!"

Neha specially highlighted Ranveer Singh's performance. She said it was 'perfection' and something 'no one else can' do. She also praised Arjun Rampal, Sara Arjun, Rakesh Bedi and the entire cast for their contributions.

The actress called Aditya Dhar a 'pure genius' for his direction. She appreciated how every shot, twist and detail made the audience feel immersed in the story.

She commended director Aditya Dhar's vision

